30 September 2026

Investment and Fees Handbook

The information in this document forms part of the **Aware Super Future Saver Product Disclosure Statement** (PDS) for:

Aware Super Future Saver Employer Sponsored and Personal dated 30 September 2026

Aware Super Future Saver NSW Police Officers dated 30 September 2026

Aware Super Future Saver Ambulance Officers dated 30 September 2026



Prepared and issued by Aware Super Pty Ltd ABN 11 118 202 672 AFSL 293340 as trustee of Aware Super ABN 53 226 460 365

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The information in this document forms part of the Aware Super Future Saver Product Disclosure Statement (PDS), which is available and can be found at **aware.com.au/pds** or by contacting the Member Support Team on **1300 650 873**. Issued by Aware Super Pty Ltd (ABN 11 118 202 672, AFSL 293340) the trustee for Aware Super (ABN 53 226 460 365). This Investment and Fees Handbook ('Handbook') has been prepared by Aware Super Pty Ltd (referred to in this document as the 'trustee', 'we', 'us', 'our'), the trustee for Aware Super (referred to in this document as 'Aware Super' or 'the fund'). The fund is governed by a trust deed ('Trust Deed') as amended from time to time. For a copy of the Trust Deed see **aware.com.au/policies** or alternatively, you can contact the Member Support Team on **1300 650 873**.

This Handbook contains general information only and does not take into account your specific objectives, financial situation or needs. Seek professional financial advice, consider your own circumstances and read the Aware Super Future Saver PDS and target market determination (TMD) before making a decision about investing in the Aware Super Future Saver product.

Contact us to make an advice appointment. Advice is provided by Aware Financial Services Australia Limited (ABN 86 003 742 756, AFSL 238430), our financial planning business which is wholly owned by us. You should read the Aware Financial Services Australia Limited Financial Services Guide before making a decision. For more information call the Member Support Team on **1300 650 873**.

The information contained in this Handbook was accurate at the time of its preparation. However, some of the information can change from time to time and the trustee can change matters which are the subject of representations made in the PDS and this Handbook. If the change is not materially adverse, the updated information will be available on our website at **aware.com.au/pdsupdates**. A paper copy of this Handbook and any update will be available free of charge by contacting us on **1300 650 873**.

We may change any matter in the PDS and this Handbook without member consent, but in the case of an increase in fees and charges we will notify members at least 30 days before the change occurs. **If there is an inconsistency between the information in this publication and the terms of the Trust Deed, the Trust Deed will prevail.**

This offer is only made to persons receiving this Handbook and the applicable PDS (electronically or otherwise) in Australia.



What to consider before you invest

There are a few things to consider before deciding how to invest your super.

Your investment timeframe

You need to consider the number of years until you expect to retire, as well as how long your savings may remain invested after you retire. This is your investment timeframe.

	Investment timeframe	
Current age	**Until retirement (age 65)**	**Until late in retirement (age 95)**
20	45 years	75 years
30	35 years	65 years
40	25 years	55 years
50	15 years	45 years
60	5 years	35 years
65	0 years	30 years

As this table shows, your super may be invested for a very long time. Short-term fluctuations in returns, even over a year or two, generally won't have a significant impact over the long term. If you have a long investment timeframe, it can therefore be a good idea to hold an investment mix with a high allocation to growth assets like shares to help maximise the returns from your super over the long term.

Your attitude to risk

All investments involve some level of risk, so it's important to consider how comfortable you are with it. How you feel about investment prices going up and down can help you work out your risk tolerance. If you choose an investment mix with a higher level of risk, it's important to be prepared to accept fluctuations in your account balance. This can help you manage your reaction to short-term market movements and stick to your long-term investment strategy.

How hands-on you want to be

If you don't make an investment choice, we'll invest your super in our default MySuper Lifecycle approach which automatically adjusts your investment mix based on your age. But if you prefer to make your own choice, we offer investment options you can mix and match based on your personal investment goals and risk tolerance.

We have a track record of delivering strong long-term returns[1] and competitive fees[2] to help our members achieve their best possible retirement outcomes.

Get in touch – we're here to help

Call us on **1300 650 873** (from outside Australia +61 3 9131 6373) and speak to a super consultant.

Browse our website
aware.com.au

Manage your account online
Visit our website to login

Speak to an adviser
We offer advice over the phone, online and in person. Call us on **1300 650 873** or visit **aware.com.au/advice** to book.

Download our app
aware.com.au/mobileapp

Our aim is to deliver the best possible retirement outcomes for our members. This means we invest for the long term and focus on choosing good-quality investments in Australia and overseas to grow your super over time.

1 Our Future Saver High Growth option delivered an average return of 9.63% p.a. over the 10 years to 30 June 2026 and ranked in the top 10 over this period per the June 2026 SuperRatings Fund Crediting Rate Survey (SR Growth (77-90) Index). Returns are after tax and investment management expenses but before administration fees. Past performance is not an indicator of future performance.

2 The total estimated annual fee (including investment fees and costs, transaction costs and administration fees) for our Future Saver High Growth option for members with a $100,000 balance is 0.85%, versus an overall average of 1.03% per the June 2026 Chant West Super Fund Fee Survey (High Growth [81-95%]).



Your investment options

Our broad range of investment options gives you choice and flexibility to suit your preferences and help you meet your investment goals.

Most of our members are invested in our default MySuper Lifecycle approach. If you don't make an investment choice, this is where we'll invest your super. But if you'd like to make your own choice, we offer nine diversified investment options and six single asset class options. You can invest in one option or a combination, and can switch options at any time free of charge.

Our investment menu

Default approach

MySuper Lifecycle

We have designed an investment approach that automatically adjusts your investment mix based on your age. This is known as MySuper Lifecycle. It uses a mix of three of our Core diversified options – High Growth, Balanced, and Conservative Balanced – to form 11 Lifecycle stages.

We do all the work for you so your super balance, future contributions and any rollovers will be automatically switched into the appropriate investment mix as you get older, helping strike a balance between risk and return to suit your age.

See 'MySuper Lifecycle' from page 5 for more details.

Choice menu

Diversified investment options

Our diversified investment options invest in different combinations of asset classes, with a mix of growth assets (like Australian and international shares) and defensive assets (like cash and fixed income). We manage the asset allocation of each diversified option.

We offer three diversified investment option styles.

Core	Socially Conscious
High Growth	High Growth Socially Conscious
Balanced	Balanced Socially Conscious
Conservative Balanced	**Indexed**
Conservative	High Growth Indexed
Defensive	Balanced Indexed

Our **Core** investment options invest across a range of investment managers and styles, and include both listed investments like shares and unlisted assets like infrastructure and property. See pages 16 to 19 for more information.

Our **Socially Conscious** options are designed for members who prefer to limit their exposure to investments we consider to have an adverse environmental or social impact. Like the Core options, these options hold both listed and unlisted assets across a range of investment managers and styles. See pages 20 to 23 for more information.

We also offer **Indexed** options for members seeking a simple, low-cost way to invest their super. The asset classes within these options are passively managed meaning they closely track a market benchmark. The Indexed options only invest in shares, fixed income and cash. See page 24 for more information.

See 'Diversified investment option styles' on page 15 for a comparison of these three investment styles.

Single asset class investment options

These are low cost options that invest in just one asset class using a passive investment style. See pages 25 to 27 for more information.

Single asset class	
Australian Shares	Bonds
International Shares	Cash[1]
Property	Term Deposit

These options allow you to be more hands-on in choosing and managing your investment strategy. However, keep in mind that not all asset classes are offered as a single asset class investment option.

Remember: If you select from our Choice menu, you are responsible for your investment selection(s) and we won't review your choice. You should review your choice from time to time because, unlike the MySuper Lifecycle approach, your account balance won't be automatically transitioned to a lower risk profile as you get older. You will remain in your selected investment option(s) until you make another selection. You can switch to our MySuper Lifecycle approach at any time.

If you choose one or more single asset class options without adequately diversifying, you may expose your super to greater risk.

We may add, close, or terminate investment options, add or remove investment managers, or alter the objectives, asset allocation targets or ranges of any Lifecycle stage or Choice option at any time. We will notify you of any material changes, although, where permitted by law, this may be after the change has occurred. If you have money in an investment option that we decide to discontinue, you may have an opportunity to switch to another of our options, or we may switch your money to an investment option with a similar risk/return profile.

1 The Cash option is actively managed.

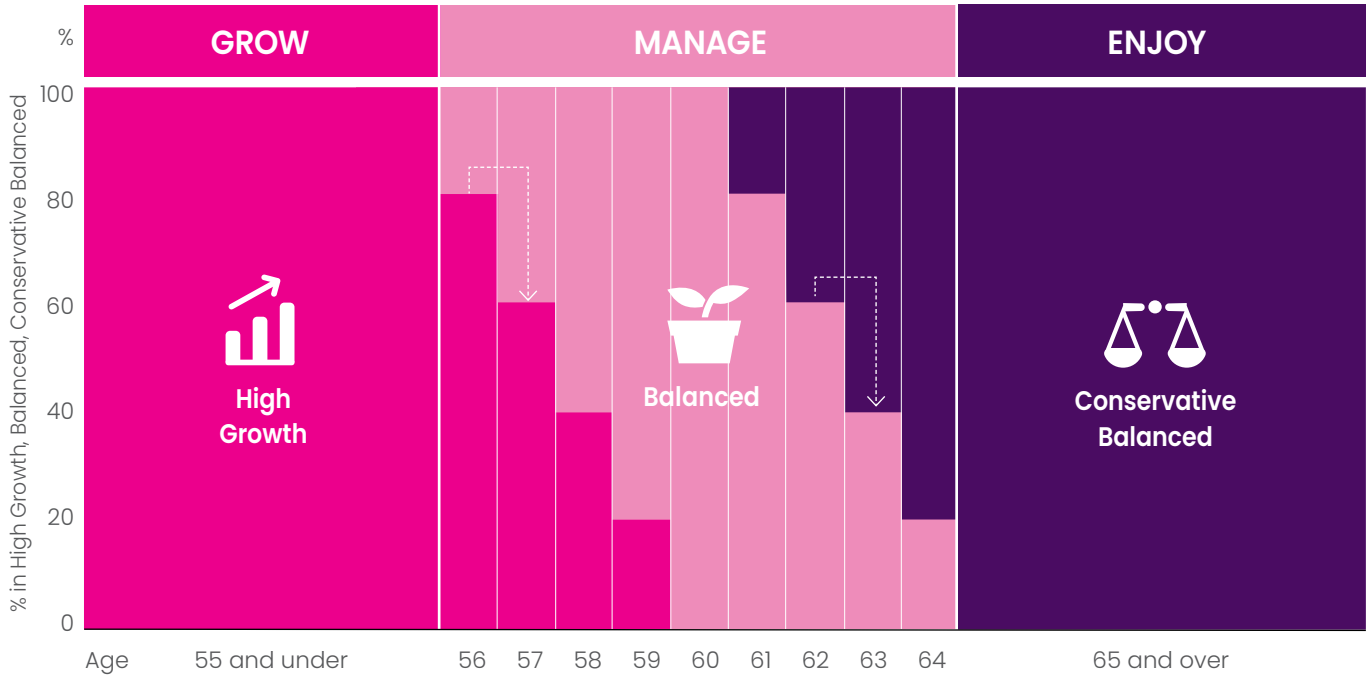
MySuper Lifecycle

If you're unsure about how to invest your super or don't want to make an investment choice, our MySuper Lifecycle approach might be suitable for you.

Your age can play a big part in what you need from your super – whether you're looking to **Grow** your savings while you're younger, **Manage** the balance between risk and return as you move through life, or **Enjoy** your savings in retirement.

Grow — Age 55 and under Stage 1	Manage — Age 56 to 64 Stages 2-10	Enjoy — Age 65 and over Stage 11
When retirement is a long time away, you have time to ride the ups and downs of investment markets, and your super can be invested in higher growth assets to maximise the growth potential of your savings. While these investments can rise and fall more in the short term, they tend to grow your balance more in the long term. During the Grow phase 100% of your balance is invested in our High Growth option.	As you get closer to retirement, your super will have less time to ride out market ups and downs. In this phase we gradually transition your investments away from the High Growth option into the Balanced option, and then into the Conservative Balanced option. Each year on your birthday,[1] small changes will automatically be made to how your account is invested. This will gradually reduce your allocation to growth assets and your investment risk over time.	During this phase, 100% of your super is invested in our Conservative Balanced option. This option invests in a fairly balanced mix of growth and defensive assets and is designed to maintain some growth in your investments while helping guard against large market falls. Though you can expect some years when returns are negative, keep in mind you will generally still have a long investment timeframe, even in retirement. Staying invested in some growth assets can help your retirement savings and income last for you.

1 If your birthday falls on a non-business day, your account will be adjusted on the following business day.



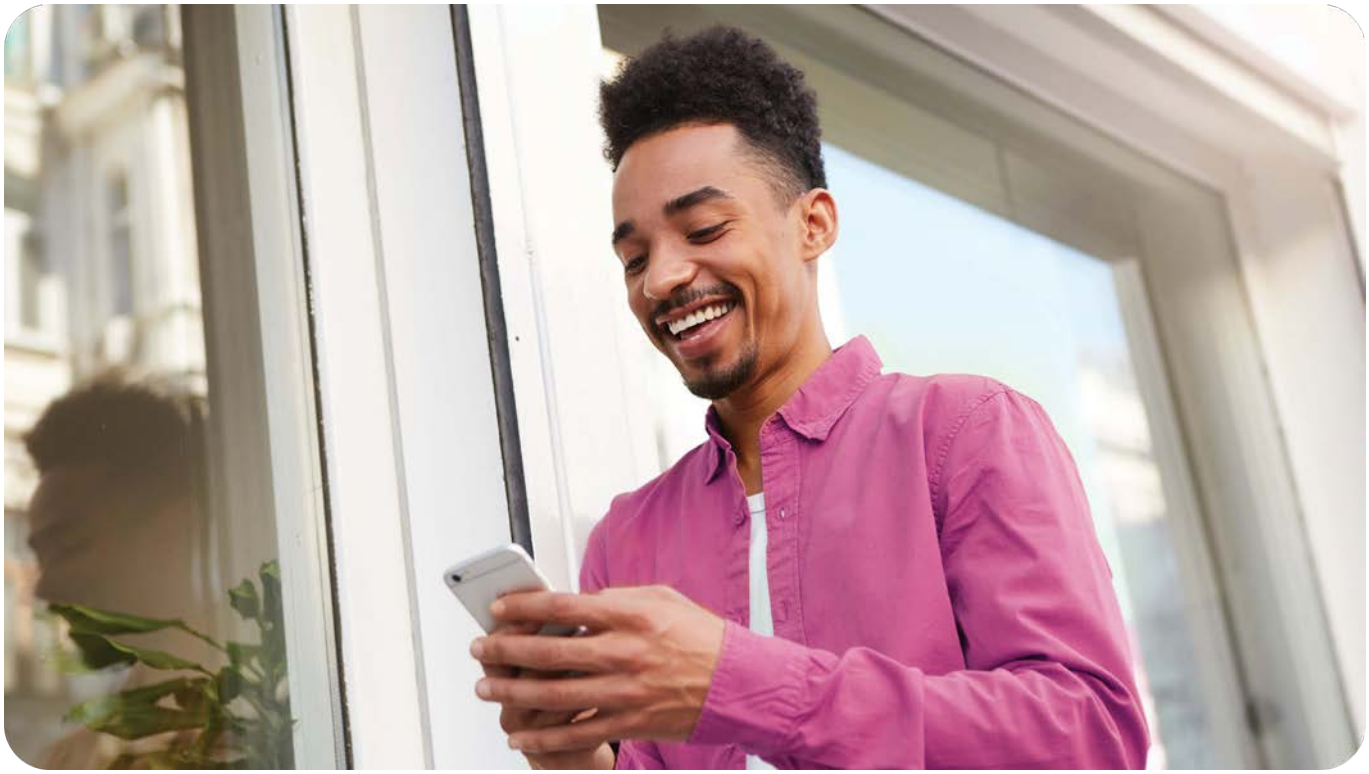
Make sure you familiarise yourself with the information under 'Making an investment choice' from page 8 – particularly the concepts of risk and volatility – so you know what to expect from your investments over time.

	Grow – Age 55 and under		Manage – Age 56		Manage – Age 57		Manage – Age 58	
Investment objective[1]	CPI + 4.00%		CPI + 3.95%		CPI + 3.90%		CPI + 3.85%	
Investment timeframe[2]	10 years		9 years		9 years		8 years	
Investment option allocation								
High Growth	100%		80%		60%		40%	
Balanced			20%		40%		60%	
Asset allocation[3]	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**
Australian shares	28.5%	18–39%	27.4%	17–38%	26.3%	16–37%	25.2%	15–35%
International shares	38.5%	28–49%	37.2%	27–48%	35.9%	26–46%	34.6%	24–45%
Private equity	6.5%	0–27%	6.2%	0–27%	5.9%	0–27%	5.6%	0–26%
Infrastructure	10.4%	0–32%	10.5%	0–32%	10.6%	0–32%	10.7%	0–32%
Property	6.5%	0–27%	6.5%	0–27%	6.5%	0–27%	6.5%	0–27%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	0.5%	0–21%	0.6%	0–21%	0.7%	0–21%	0.8%	0–21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0.0%	0–10%	0.0%	0–10%	0.0%	0–10%	0.0%	0–10%
Credit income	2.4%	0–23%	2.9%	0–24%	3.4%	0–24%	3.9%	0–25%
Fixed income	0.0%	0–10%	2.0%	0–13%	4.0%	0–16%	6.0%	0–19%
Cash	6.7%	0–15%	6.7%	0–21%	6.7%	0–27%	6.7%	0–33%
Growth/defensive target[4]								
Growth assets	86%		84%		81%		79%	
Defensive assets	14%		16%		19%		21%	
Risk								
Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period[5]	4 to less than 6		4 to less than 6		4 to less than 6		4 to less than 6	
Short-term risk (market volatility)[5]	6 - High		6 - High		6 - High		6 - High	
Long-term risk (insufficient return)[6]	2 - Low		2 - Low		2 - Low		2 - Low	

	Manage – Age 59		Manage – Age 60		Manage – Age 61		Manage – Age 62	
Investment objective[1]	CPI + 3.80%		CPI + 3.75%		CPI + 3.55%		CPI + 3.35%	
Investment timeframe[2]	8 years		7 years		7 years		6 years	
Investment option allocation								
High Growth	20%							
Balanced	80%		100%		80%		60%	
Conservative Balanced					20%		40%	
Asset allocation[3]	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**
Australian shares	24.1%	14–34%	23.0%	13–33%	21.7%	12–32%	20.4%	10–31%
International shares	33.3%	23–43%	32.0%	22–42%	30.2%	20–40%	28.4%	18–38%
Private equity	5.3%	0–26%	5.0%	0–26%	4.8%	0–26%	4.6%	0–26%
Infrastructure	10.8%	0–32%	10.9%	0–32%	10.7%	0–32%	10.5%	0–32%
Property	6.5%	0–27%	6.5%	0–27%	6.7%	0–27%	6.9%	0–27%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	0.9%	0–21%	1.0%	0–21%	1.0%	0–21%	1.0%	0–21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0.0%	0–10%	0.0%	0–10%	0.0%	0–12%	0.0%	0–14%
Credit income	4.4%	0–25%	4.9%	0–26%	5.3%	0–26%	5.7%	0–27%
Fixed income	8.0%	0–22%	10.0%	0–25%	12.3%	0–28%	14.6%	0–31%
Cash	6.7%	0–39%	6.7%	0–45%	7.3%	0–48%	7.9%	0–51%
Growth/defensive target[4]								
Growth assets	76%		74%		71%		67%	
Defensive assets	24%		26%		29%		33%	
Risk								
Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period[5]	3 to less than 4		3 to less than 4		3 to less than 4		3 to less than 4	
Short-term risk (market volatility)[5]	5 - Med to High		5 - Med to High		5 - Med to High		5 - Med to High	
Long-term risk (insufficient return)[6]	2 - Low		2 - Low		2 - Low		2 - Low	

	Manage – Age 63		Manage – Age 64		Enjoy – Age 65 and over	
Investment objective[1]	CPI + 3.15%		CPI + 2.95%		CPI + 2.75%	
Investment timeframe[2]	6 years		5 years		5 years	
Investment option allocation						
Balanced	40%		20%			
Conservative Balanced	60%		80%		100%	
Asset allocation[3]	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**	**Target**	**Range**
Australian shares	19.1%	9–29%	17.8%	7–28%	16.5%	6–27%
International shares	26.6%	17–37%	24.8%	15–35%	23.0%	13–33%
Private equity	4.4%	0–25%	4.2%	0–25%	4.0%	0–25%
Infrastructure	10.3%	0–31%	10.1%	0–31%	9.9%	0–31%
Property	7.1%	0–28%	7.3%	0–28%	7.5%	0–28%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	1.0%	0–21%	1.0%	0–21%	1.0%	0–21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0.0%	0–16%	0.0%	0–18%	0.0%	0–20%
Credit income	6.1%	0–27%	6.5%	0–28%	6.9%	0–28%
Fixed income	16.9%	0–34%	19.2%	0–37%	21.5%	0–40%
Cash	8.5%	0–54%	9.1%	0–57%	9.7%	0–60%
Growth/defensive target[4]						
Growth assets	64%		60%		57%	
Defensive assets	36%		40%		43%	
Risk						
Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period[5]	3 to less than 4		3 to less than 4		2 to less than 3	
Short-term risk (market volatility)[5]	5 - Med to High		5 - Med to High		4 - Med	
Long-term risk (insufficient return)[6]	3 – Low to Medium		3 – Low to Medium		3 – Low to Medium	

1 Per annum over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax. Investment objectives can't be relied on as a forecast of future performance, but they can give you an idea of the expected return. We periodically review the investment objective for each Lifecycle stage and investment option and may change them from time to time.
2 The minimum investment timeframe we suggest for our MySuper Lifecycle approach overall. This may vary depending on your age when you start investing in Lifecycle.
3 How the investment option is spread across different asset classes. Targets are as at the date of this *Handbook* though we typically review the asset allocations of each option annually and may adjust them from time to time. For more information see 'Asset allocation' on page 14.
4 The Lifecycle stage's mix of growth assets like shares, and defensive assets like cash and fixed income. See 'Understanding asset classes' from page 12 for more information.
5 A measure of market volatility that indicates the likelihood of negative returns. It utilises the same methodology as the Standard Risk Measure, which is an estimate of the number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period. See 'Understanding risk and return' from page 9 for more information.
6 The risk of the Lifecycle stage not providing a sufficient return above inflation to stay ahead of the rising cost of living and allow you to maintain your lifestyle in retirement. See 'Understanding risk and return' from page 9 for more information.



Making an investment choice

This section is designed to help you navigate the ins and outs of investing your super.

Make sure you read this section and consider your options carefully, especially if you decide to choose your own investment mix rather than invest in our MySuper Lifecycle approach. You should also review your choices from time to time to make sure they remain appropriate for your circumstances, especially as you get closer to retirement. And get in touch if you need help.

The investment decisions you make today can make a big difference to the amount of super you retire with. Learning the basics of investing will help you make better decisions now and in the future.

Super helpful tip: Different investment options carry different levels of risk depending on the assets that make up the option. When choosing an investment option, you should consider the level of investment risk that is appropriate for you. This will depend on factors such as your age, investment timeframe, where other parts of your wealth are invested, and your attitude to risk.

Understanding risk and return

To grow your super over the long term, you need to take some risk. All investments involve some level of risk. The level of risk depends largely on the type of investments, known as asset classes, you're invested in. But that's not the whole picture. It's also important to consider the key short-term and long-term risks described below to help you select the right investment option for your circumstances.

Key investment concepts



Risk

The chance the return on an investment will be different (higher or lower) from what you expected.



Volatility

The amount of variability in an investment's return, either positive or negative.



Return

The sum of the income earned by an investment plus the amount it goes up or down in value over time.

Risk and volatility are related. If an investment is more volatile, there is a higher risk of not meeting your shorter-term return expectations, but generally a lower risk of not meeting your longer-term return expectations.

Short-term risk – market volatility

Market volatility – market ups and downs – is one of the main investment risks over shorter time periods (less than five years).

In general, the higher the long-term return you're aiming for, the greater the risk your investment will go up and down in value in the short term. For example, shares typically produce strong long-term returns but can be volatile in the short term, which can make for a bumpy ride.

As a result, returns from investment options with a high allocation to shares and other growth assets can vary a lot, and there is a greater chance of a negative return in any one year. By comparison, options which invest mostly in defensive assets like cash and fixed income tend to produce lower but more stable returns.

Long-term risk – returns being less than required

Market ups and downs aren't the only risk to consider. As super is a long-term investment for most people, there is a risk that your investments don't generate a sufficient return above inflation over longer periods (10+ years) to stay ahead of the rising cost of living and allow you to maintain your lifestyle in retirement. Inflation reduces the buying power of your savings, meaning what you buy now could cost a lot more by the time you retire. For example, if we assume an average annual inflation rate of 2.5%, in 30 years' time everyday items like a cup of coffee or loaf of bread will cost more than double what they do today. Inflation is therefore something you need to think about when making an investment choice, particularly if you have a longer investment timeframe.

In general, investment options with a higher weighting to growth assets are expected to outperform inflation over the long term. By contrast, options that invest mostly in defensive assets may not earn a sufficient return above inflation to provide you with enough money for retirement.

Risk levels of investment options

When choosing your investment option(s), the risks you need to consider may differ depending on how long you plan to invest and when you will begin drawing an income from your super. Refer to the investment timeframe on page 1 to think about how long your super will be invested, how long you have to ride out market ups and downs, and how this could impact your investment choices.

To help guide you we've provided estimated short-term and long-term risk measures for each investment option (see from page 16) and Lifecycle stage (see from page 6).

	Short term	Long term
Investing for	Less than 5 years	10 years +
Key risk	Not having enough time to recover from adverse market movements, i.e. market volatility.	Your investments not generating a sufficient return above inflation, i.e. insufficient returns.
Risk measure[1]	The likelihood of a negative annual return in a given year. The short-term risk measure utilises the same methodology as the Standard Risk Measure.	The likelihood of returns being less than CPI[2] +3.5% p.a. This is the approximate return the average member will require from their super while they're working to be able to maintain their lifestyle in retirement.

1 To learn more about how we calculate the short-term and long-term risk measures, including the assumptions and limitations, visit **aware.com.au/investmentandrisk**.
2 The Consumer Price Index, the official measure of inflation.

These risk measures can help you choose the right investment for your circumstances.

- Are you investing your super for a long time? If so, long-term risk will usually be most relevant. You may want to invest your savings into an option(s) with a low long-term risk measure and a higher allocation to growth assets that is expected to grow your savings above inflation over time.
- Do you plan to start spending your savings over the next five or so years (for example, because you are approaching retirement)? If so, both short-term and long-term risk will likely be important because a market downturn at this time would mean you have less time for your savings to recover. Choosing an option with a lower allocation to growth assets may be more appropriate and would put you in a well-rounded position across both risk measures.

Our MySuper Lifecycle approach is designed to align with the level of short-term and long-term risk that is suitable for your age. In Lifecycle, until age 56 your super is invested in our High Growth option which has a long-term risk measure of '2 – Low' and a short-term risk measure of '6 – High'. This suggests there is a low risk of not keeping up with inflation over the long term, though you will likely need to ride out some market ups and downs along the way. Between ages 56 and 65 your super is gradually transitioned into our Conservative Balanced option which puts you in a well-rounded position across both risk measures.

Whatever your choice, remember that all investment options, apart from the Cash and Term Deposit options, will experience some market volatility.

Make sure you select an investment option you're comfortable holding through market ups and downs for the recommended minimum timeframe.

Selecting an investment option with the right risk level for you is important because it can have a significant impact on your account balance and the amount of income you receive in retirement.

However, keep in mind that your super savings, and therefore the income you receive in retirement, will be impacted by a range of factors. This includes the number of years you work and contribute to super, the size of your contributions and whether you withdraw any of your super early.

Significant investment risks

All investments are subject to varying risks. Before choosing how to invest your super you should consider the risks associated with investing. The below table summarises some key investment risks.

Market volatility risk	The risk of the market ups and downs reducing the value of your savings.
Longevity risk	The risk that you live longer than your savings can provide for you financially in retirement.
Inflation risk	The risk that your super doesn't keep up with the rising cost of living over time (inflation).
Market timing risk	The risk that trying to predict and time the market, such as when switching options, leads to buying or selling investments at the wrong time, impacting your returns.
Sequencing risk	The risk of weak or negative market returns at an inopportune time, such as the start of retirement. Our MySuper Lifecycle approach helps mitigate this risk by transitioning members gradually between the High Growth and Conservative Balanced options from ages 56 to 65.
Illiquidity risk	The risk that an investment can't be sold quickly without a loss in value. We reduce this risk by limiting our illiquid investments (like unlisted property and infrastructure) and regularly monitoring liquidity.
Currency risk	The risk associated with movements in exchange rates. A higher Australian dollar can reduce returns on international investments, while a lower Australian dollar can improve returns.
Interest rate risk	Changes in interest rates can affect the value of investments. For example, when interest rates go up, the value of fixed income investments such as bonds typically decreases. When interest rates go down, the value of these investments typically increases. Our Bonds and more conservative diversified investment options are most sensitive to this risk.
Climate risk	The risk that not taking action on climate change, or the consequences of climate change itself, will adversely affect the investment performance of specific sectors, companies or assets.
Gearing (leverage) risk	Borrowing to invest amplifies the potential gains and losses from an investment. We manage this risk by limiting and monitoring gearing in our investment options.
Counterparty risk	The risk of loss if another party in a transaction can't meet its payment obligations. Investment products such as bonds and derivatives carry counterparty risk.

Did you know?

30 years from now, assuming an annual inflation rate of 2.5%, you will need more than twice the amount of money to buy what you can today.

Diversify to manage risk

While investment risk can't be completely removed, there are some strategies that may assist in managing it. One way to manage investment risk is to spread your money across different types of investments and asset classes. This is called diversification.

Diversifying your investments can reduce the amount of money you could lose if one investment or asset class performs poorly. This is because not all investments and asset classes perform in the same way at the same time. For example, when shares are performing poorly, bonds may be performing well, so a portfolio that holds both should produce a more stable overall return.

Investments can be diversified across different asset classes, industries, securities and countries, as well as across investment managers with different approaches. The more you diversify, the less impact any one investment can have on your overall returns.

Understanding asset classes

Asset classes are the building blocks of our investment options.

We invest in a range of asset classes. An asset class is a grouping of investments with similar characteristics, for example cash or Australian shares. Our diversified investment options invest in a mix of asset classes, while our single asset class options hold just one.

Growth vs defensive assets

Asset classes fall into two main groups – growth and defensive – with some a blend of the two.

This classification is important to understand as it indicates the riskiness of the different asset classes and, therefore, of the investment options that invest in them.

Asset class type	Description	Asset classes
Growth assets 	• Aim to increase the value of your investment over the long-term i.e. provide long-term capital growth. • Have historically produced higher investment returns than defensive assets. • Returns are mostly from a change in value (i.e. from prices moving up and down) rather than income. • Carry a higher risk of negative returns over the short term.	• Australian shares • International shares • Private equity
Defensive assets 	• Aim to protect the value of your investment. • May help provide positive returns when share markets are weak. • Returns mostly come from income such as interest, rather than a change in value. • Returns are usually more modest than growth assets and may not keep pace with inflation. • Carry a lower risk of negative returns than growth assets (though returns can still be negative).	• Cash • Fixed income • Credit income
A mix of growth and defensive assets 	• Asset classes with a mix of growth and defensive characteristics.	• Infrastructure • Property • Liquid alternatives

Liquid vs illiquid investments

- Liquid investments can be easily sold and converted into cash, such as shares and bonds.
- Illiquid investments can't be converted into cash for a fair market value quickly or easily. They include unlisted property, unlisted infrastructure and private equity. These are often long-term investments which can match well with the typically long-term investment horizon of super. They can also help increase diversification.

Our Core and Socially Conscious diversified options invest in a mix of liquid and illiquid investments, while our Indexed and single asset class options hold only liquid investments.

Our asset classes

See the below descriptions of our asset classes to help you understand how your super is invested.[1]

Growth assets

Australian and international shares

A portion (or share) of a company that can be bought and sold on a stock exchange. Includes both large and small companies across a range of industries both in Australia and overseas.

Private equity

Investments in Australian and overseas companies that aren't listed on a stock exchange. These can be large established companies needing investment and expertise to support future growth plans, as well as smaller, rapidly growing businesses.

Defensive assets

Fixed income

A loan to a government or large corporation that pays regular interest over a set term. Like most other investments, the value of fixed income investments such as bonds can go up and down, and they can experience periods of low or negative returns. Their value tends to move in the opposite direction to interest rates. This means when interest rates rise, fixed income securities tend to fall in value, and when interest rates fall, their value will typically rise.

Credit income

Covers a range of debt investments which, like fixed income, involve lending money to a borrower. However, compared to fixed income, the borrowers usually have a higher credit risk profile and the loans are often floating rate. This means the potential returns are typically higher than traditional fixed income, although the risk of default is also greater.

Cash

Includes term deposits and other short-term interest-bearing investments issued by banks. The cash allocation within our diversified options can also include other short-term to medium-term money market and debt securities that have a higher risk than traditional cash assets, but also the potential for higher returns.

1 These descriptions may not cover all types of investments included in our asset classes.

A mix of growth and defensive assets

Infrastructure

Includes investments in unlisted infrastructure assets that provide essential public facilities and services across a number of sectors including transport, renewables and energy transition, utilities, social, registries and digital/telecommunications. Our infrastructure asset class can include both these facilities and services directly, and investments in the entities that own and operate them.

From time to time the infrastructure asset class may also hold a small amount of listed infrastructure assets.

Property

Can include both unlisted and listed property. Unlisted property assets include office buildings, industrial estates, shopping centres and residential property, as well as investments in property operating platforms which are property businesses that own and operate property assets in different sectors.

Listed property assets are property owning entities and property businesses listed on a share market. Their returns can be impacted by general share market sentiment. As a result, they are generally higher risk investments compared to unlisted property, and have more volatile returns. Listed property is classified as a growth asset.

Liquid alternatives

Includes a broad range of alternative investments such as real return strategies and hedge funds which are designed to provide diversification over different market cycles. Liquid alternatives managers have a wide range of allowable investments and can use a combination of shares, bonds, currencies, commodities and other liquid investments. They can invest in these asset classes directly or through the use of derivatives.

We invest in both growth-oriented and defensively-oriented liquid alternatives strategies.

Super helpful tip: Go to **aware.com.au/assetclasses** for more information on our asset classes, including examples of some of our unlisted investments.

Asset allocation

How an investment option is spread across different asset classes is known as its asset allocation, and is a key driver of long-term returns. For each diversified option, we have determined the asset allocation we believe is most appropriate for its investment objective and risk level. Asset allocation ranges are also assigned, setting the minimum and maximum we can invest in each asset class. These targets and ranges are typically reviewed annually and may change from time-to-time.

We actively manage the asset allocation of the Core and Socially Conscious investment options. This means we may deviate from the target asset allocation and adjust the investment mix depending on our outlook for the economy and investment markets. Our active asset allocation approach is designed to add incremental returns by increasing exposures to asset classes or specific sectors when they are attractive, or to help shield members from emerging risks.

Each option's actual asset allocation constantly changes with movements in asset values, the buying and selling of assets and our active asset allocation approach. While usually remaining within given ranges, actual asset allocations may temporarily move outside these ranges, for example during periods of significant market stress.

You can find the asset allocation targets and ranges for each option in the 'Investment option profiles' section, and for each Lifecycle stage in the 'MySuper Lifecycle' section. Actual asset allocations are published periodically at **aware.com.au/assetallocations**.



Diversified investment option styles

Below is an overview of our three types of diversified options to help you understand their key features and differences.

Investment feature	Core[1]	Socially Conscious	Indexed	See section	Page number
Liquid investments	✓	✓	✓	Liquid vs illiquid investments	12
Illiquid investments	✓	✓	✗		
Active asset allocation	✓	✓	✗	Asset allocation	14
Passively managed investments	✓	✓	✓	Active vs passive management	30
Actively managed investments	✓	✓	✗[2]		
Internally managed investments	✓	✓	✗[2]	Investment managers	30
Externally managed investments	✓	✓	✓		
Our fund-wide Responsible Ownership approach	✓	✓	✓	Responsible Ownership	30
Our Socially Conscious investment approach	✗	✓	✗	Socially Conscious diversified investment options	20

1 Includes the High Growth, Balanced, Conservative Balanced, Conservative and Defensive investment options.
2 Excludes the Cash asset class which is actively managed in-house.

Investment option profiles

On the following pages you'll find more detail about each investment option. Below is a guide to help you understand what each section in the table means.

High Growth

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a strong focus on growth assets such as shares and private equity.

A summary of what the option invests in.

Who might invest in this option?

Members with a long-term investment horizon looking to maximise long-term growth. Best suited to members who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

The type of members the option may be suitable for.

Investment objective

CPI + 4.00% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

The desired investment outcome for the option. Some options are designed to provide a return above inflation and others to track or exceed a market index. Investment objectives can't be relied on as a forecast of future performance, but they can give you an idea of the expected return.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	28.5%	18-39%
International shares	38.5%	28-49%
Private equity	6.5%	0-27%
Infrastructure	10.4%	0-32%
Property	6.5%	0-27%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	0.5%	0-21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0%	0-10%
Credit income	2.4%	0-23%
Fixed income	0%	0-10%
Cash	6.7%	0-15%

How the option is spread across different asset classes. As at the date of this *Handbook*. For more information see 'Asset allocation' on page 14.

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	86%
Defensive assets	14%

How the option is split between growth assets and defensive assets.

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

The recommended minimum period you should invest in this option.

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	4 to less than 6
Short-term risk (market volatility):	6 - High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	2 - Low

How risky the option is considered to be over different time periods. **Short-term risk** is a measure of the option's volatility. **Long-term risk** is the likelihood the option doesn't generate a sufficient return above inflation for you to maintain your lifestyle in retirement. See 'Understanding risk and return' from page 9 for more information.

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
9.63% p.a	7.56% p.a	10.46% p.a

The average annual return the option has achieved for each time period to 30 June 2026 (after investment fees and costs, transaction costs, and tax, but before administration fees).

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.44%
Transaction costs:	0.08%

An estimate of the investment fees and costs and transaction costs of the option. These amounts can vary from year to year. See 'Fees and other costs' from page 38 for more information.

The value of assets in the fund's investment options may rise and fall. Nothing in this *Handbook* is intended to forecast the future performance of the fund or any of its investment options. We do not guarantee the capital invested or the investment performance of any of our investment options.

Past performance is not a reliable indicator nor is it a guarantee of future performance.

Core diversified investment options

These options invest across different asset classes, investment managers and investment styles to provide a high level of diversification.

High Growth

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a strong focus on growth assets such as shares and private equity.

Who might invest in this option?

Members with a long-term investment horizon looking to maximise long-term growth. Best suited to members who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 4.00% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	28.5%	18-39%
International shares	38.5%	28-49%
Private equity	6.5%	0-27%
Infrastructure	10.4%	0-32%
Property	6.5%	0-27%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	0.5%	0-21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0%	0-10%
Credit income	2.4%	0-23%
Fixed income	0%	0-10%
Cash	6.7%	0-15%

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	86%
Defensive assets	14%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	4 to less than 6
Short-term risk (market volatility):	6 - High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	2 - Low

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
9.63% p.a	7.56% p.a	10.46% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.44%
Transaction costs:	0.08%

Balanced

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a focus on growth assets such as shares and private equity.

Who might invest in this option?

Members with a long-term investment horizon seeking strong long-term returns. Best suited to members who are comfortable with fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 3.75% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	23%	13-33%
International shares	32%	22-42%
Private equity	5%	0-26%
Infrastructure	10.9%	0-32%
Property	6.5%	0-27%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	1%	0-21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0%	0-10%
Credit income	4.9%	0-26%
Fixed income	10%	0-25%
Cash	6.7%	0-45%

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	74%
Defensive assets	26%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

7 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	3 to less than 4
Short-term risk (market volatility):	5 - Medium to High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	2 - Low

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
8.22% p.a	6.66% p.a	9.39% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.40%
Transaction costs:	0.08%

Core diversified investment options (continued)

Conservative Balanced

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a slight focus on growth assets such as shares and private equity.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking a balance between capital growth and capital stability who can tolerate some years when returns are negative.

Investment objective

CPI + 2.75% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	16.5%	6-27%
International shares	23%	13-33%
Private equity	4%	0-25%
Infrastructure	9.9%	0-31%
Property	7.5%	0-28%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	1%	0-21%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0%	0-20%
Credit income	6.9%	0-28%
Fixed income	21.5%	0-40%
Cash	9.7%	0-60%

Growth/defensive target

Growth assets	57%
Defensive assets	43%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

5 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	2 to less than 3
Short-term risk (market volatility):	4 - Medium
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	3 - Low to Medium

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
6.49% p.a	5.52% p.a	7.85% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.38%
Transaction costs:	0.07%

Conservative

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a slight focus on defensive assets such as cash and fixed income.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking modest capital growth in the short to medium term. Best suited to members who are less comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 1.75% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	9%	0-19%
International shares	13%	3-23%
Private equity	2%	0-23%
Infrastructure	9.9%	0-31%
Property	7.5%	0-28%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	0%	0-10%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0%	0-20%
Credit income	7.9%	0-29%
Fixed income	28.5%	0-49%
Cash	22.2%	0-75%

Growth/defensive target

Growth assets	37%
Defensive assets	63%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

4 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	1 to less than 2
Short-term risk (market volatility):	3 - Low to Medium
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	5 - Medium to High

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
5.18% p.a	4.46% p.a	6.27% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.31%
Transaction costs:	0.05%

Core diversified investment options (continued)

Defensive

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a focus on defensive assets such as cash and fixed income.

Who might invest in this option?

Members with a short-term to medium-term investment horizon seeking fairly stable returns. However, remember that in exchange for more stable returns over the short term you may be sacrificing the potential for higher long-term returns.

Investment objective

CPI + 1.00% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	5%	0-15%
International shares	8%	0-18%
Private equity	1%	0-22%
Infrastructure	7.4%	0-29%
Property	5%	0-26%
Liquid alternatives (growth)	0%	0-10%
Liquid alternatives (defensive)	0%	0-20%
Credit income	5.4%	0-26%
Fixed income	20%	0-45%
Cash	48.2%	0-85%

Growth/defensive target

Growth assets	23%
Defensive assets	77%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

3 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	0.5 to less than 1
Short-term risk (market volatility):	2 - Low
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	6 - High

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
4.08% p.a	3.77% p.a	5.55% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.22%
Transaction costs:	0.03%

Socially Conscious diversified investment options

We offer two Socially Conscious investment options for members who prefer to limit their investment in companies we consider to have a highly adverse environmental or social impact. As well as following our Responsible Ownership approach (see from page 30), investments in the Socially Conscious options are selected and managed according to additional and stricter restrictions known as screens.

These options invest in a range of asset types (listed and unlisted), investment managers and styles.

The exclusion or restriction of certain sectors/investments from these options will impact returns when those sectors/investments perform well or poorly.

Screening criteria

The screening criteria – the screens themselves and how they are applied – are set out in the tables below.[1] The Socially Conscious options will not invest in companies and other entities involved in the below activities where the stated thresholds are met. The screening criteria apply to all asset classes (with some differentiation in private equity). We use data from our ESG data provider, ISS STOXX, to screen Australian shares, international shares and fixed income investments.[2] For other asset classes, our Responsible Investments team assesses new investments before they are made to ensure they meet the screening criteria.

Please note:

- Up to 5% of the private equity asset class may be invested in companies and other entities not meeting the screening criteria, other than the tobacco, nicotine-alternatives and tobacco-based products, and controversial weapons screens.
- The screening criteria do not apply to derivatives, securitised assets (financial products that give the holder exposure to a pool of loans, bonds or other debt products), or non-cash collateral held under the fund's securities lending program. This means derivatives and securitised assets may have an indirect exposure to companies or other entities involved in the below activities.
- Continuous application of the screens may not always be possible. This may result in inadvertent holdings, typically over the short term, in investments we are seeking to exclude. See 'Ongoing monitoring and limitations of our screening process' on page 22 for more information.
- We do not exclude companies that provide goods or services to entities generating revenue from the below activities or that are involved in the distribution or deployment of these products, unless otherwise stated.
- We do not automatically exclude companies' subsidiaries, joint ventures or bond issuers; each is assessed on its own verifiable involvement in the relevant activity. For example, if a company is excluded due to its involvement in controversial weapons, its subsidiary will only be excluded if it is assessed to be verifiably involved in controversial weapons based on its own activities.

Climate change screens

Screen	Description	Threshold
Fossil fuel exploration or production	Fossil fuel exploration[3], extraction, production, refining, processing, and/or electricity generation. Fossil fuels include coal[4] (thermal, energy and metallurgical), conventional oil and gas, unconventional oil (oil sands, tar sands and shale oil) and gas (coal seam gas and shale gas).	5% or more of revenue
Fossil fuel transportation	Includes fossil fuel (coal, oil and gas) storage and transportation including pipelines, storage tanks, freight, rail and ports.	5% or more of revenue
Fossil fuel supply chain and services	Directly owning and/or supplying fossil fuel (coal, oil and gas) mining equipment, oil and gas equipment and services. This screen does not include companies that provide services to the fossil fuel industry whose purpose is to support the transition to a lower carbon economy.	5% or more of revenue
Fossil fuel reserves	Companies that hold fossil fuel reserves (whether proven or probable) with the intention of exploration and/or development of those reserves for revenue generation (rather than for own use).	No threshold

1 As at the date of this *Handbook*. The screening criteria are periodically reviewed by our Responsible Investments team and may be updated from time to time.
2 For details on ISS STOXX's methodology, visit **issgovernance.com/esg/methodology-information/**. Key documents include the 'Energy & Extractives Screening', 'Controversial Weapons Research' and 'Sector-Based Screening' papers.
3 Exploration means companies engaged in pre-production stages of the extraction of fossil fuels, including prospecting for, acquiring, exploring, and developing resources prior to the point where the production of commercially recoverable quantities commences.
4 There is a fund-wide restriction on companies generating 10% or more of their revenues directly from mining thermal or energy coal. A lower (i.e. stricter) threshold of 5% is applied to the Socially Conscious options and extends to other forms of coal, such as metallurgical coal. The Socially Conscious screen also incorporates extraction, production, refining, processing and mining, and applies to all investments (other than derivatives, securitised assets and non-cash collateral).

Ethical screens

Screen	Description	Threshold
Tobacco, nicotine alternatives and tobacco-based products[5, 6]	Production/manufacture of tobacco, nicotine alternatives and tobacco-based products.	No threshold
Gambling	Production, distribution or provision of services in relation to gambling.	5% or more of revenue
Alcohol	Production of alcohol.	5% or more of revenue
Pornography	Production and/or distribution of pornography.	5% or more of revenue
Uranium	Uranium mining.	5% or more of revenue
Nuclear power	Nuclear power production and/or generation.	5% or more of revenue
Civilian firearms	Production and/or distribution of civilian firearms and related services.	5% or more of revenue
Military equipment	Production and/or distribution of military equipment (combat and non-combat) and related services.[7]	5% or more of revenue
Live animal exports	Owning and/or operating live animal export operations.	No threshold

Conventions and controversies-based screens

Screen	Description	Threshold
Controversial weapons[6]	Companies verifiably involved in[8] the development, production, acquisition, stockpiling, retention or transfer of controversial weapons (whole systems or key components[9]), as well as companies that provide assistance in any of these activities. Controversial weapons means anti-personnel mines, biological weapons, chemical weapons, cluster munitions, depleted uranium, incendiary weapons, white phosphorous weapons and nuclear weapons.	No threshold
Corporate controversies	Companies consistently involved in very severe incidents/corporate controversies, or that are believed to be at high risk of being involved in serious incidents in the future (see examples below).	Exclusion is at Aware Super's discretion

5 Nicotine alternatives and tobacco-based products include, for example, vaping devices and e-cigarettes.
6 While there are fund-wide restrictions in relation to tobacco and controversial weapons, the Socially Conscious screens are broader and are not subject to a materiality threshold. See '4: Investment restrictions' from page 32 for details.
7 The scope of military equipment and related services is based on international arms export control standards, and does not cover equipment, products or components that were not designed or modified on the basis of military specifications (e.g. commercial off-the-shelf products).
8 For liquid investments such as shares and bonds, this verification is undertaken by ISS STOXX. For unlisted investments, an internal assessment is made.
9 A component is a key component if it plays an essential role in the functionality of the specified weapon system or is specifically designed or modified for the specified weapons.

Exclusion of an investment as a result of the 'Corporate controversies' screen will be based on an assessment by our Responsible Investments team. Where available, relevant screens/scores from external ESG data providers will be considered as part of the assessment. Examples of corporate controversies that may result in a company being excluded from the Socially Conscious options include:

- Environmental, ecological and biodiversity wrongdoings: including companies that have been repeatedly fined for breaching regulatory requirements with regard to excessive or unauthorised emissions of CO^2 and other greenhouse gases, water supply contamination and/or improper waste management practices.
- Bribery and corruption: including both authenticated allegations and convicted violations.
- A lack of commitment to engagement with and cultural sensitivity towards indigenous people and local communities.
- Violation of human rights: including companies not adhering to the UN Guiding Principles for Business and Human Rights, for example by engaging in child labour, or otherwise not upholding international labour standards.
- Significant corporate governance failings: including companies that fail to adequately investigate and implement preventative measures in relation to material corporate governance issues.
- Serious health and safety failings: including companies that fail to adequately investigate and implement preventative measures in relation to material health and safety issues.

Discretionary exclusions

Our Responsible Investments team may determine that an investment is unsuitable for the Socially Conscious options for reasons not covered by the criteria above. In these cases, the investment may be excluded or removed. We may engage with the company or issuer, but this is not required. An investment will only be re-included if meaningful improvements have been demonstrated. A plan to improve alone is not sufficient.

Ongoing monitoring and limitations of our screening process

The Socially Conscious options' investments are periodically reviewed to ensure they meet the criteria for inclusion. For liquid investments like shares and bonds, a quarterly review of the holdings against the screening criteria is undertaken. For unlisted assets such as property and infrastructure, a detailed assessment is undertaken prior to the initial investment, and at least once a year thereafter, to ensure the screening criteria continue to be met.

If an investment is identified as not meeting the criteria, it will be sold or removed from the Socially Conscious options as soon as reasonably practicable, subject to liquidity constraints. Note that implementation of the screening criteria may be affected by the accessibility and accuracy of data or external service provider errors. This may result in inadvertent holdings, typically over the short term, in investments we are seeking to exclude.

Investment managers

We have appointed specialist external investment managers to manage the Australian and international shares asset classes within the Socially Conscious options. These managers must adhere to our screening criteria outlined above. They may also have their own responsible investment guidelines for labour standards and environmental, social and ethical considerations, and their own methodology for taking these aspects into account when selecting, retaining and selling investments.

For all other asset classes in the Socially Conscious options, we use the same investment managers (both internal and external) as the Core investment options, where relevant. These investments are still subject to the Socially Conscious screening criteria.

Responsible Investment Association Australasia certification

The RI Certification Symbol is issued by Responsible Investment Association Australasia (RIAA) ACN (641 046 666), AFSL (554110) and signifies that a product or service offers an investment style that takes into account environmental, social, governance or ethical considerations. The Symbol also signifies that the **High Growth Socially Conscious** and **Balanced Socially Conscious** investment options adhere to the operational and disclosure practices required under the Responsible Investment Certification Program for the category of Product and are assessed against RIAA's Responsible Investment Standard. The Certification Symbol is a Trademark of RIAA. For detailed information about RIAA, the Symbol and Aware Super's methodology, performance, stock holdings, remuneration and details about other responsible investment products certified by RIAA, refer to **www.responsiblereturns.com.au** and the RIAA **Financial Services Guide**.[1]

1 The Responsible Investment Certification Program provides general advice only and does not take into account any person's objectives, financial situation, or needs. Neither the Certification Symbol nor RIAA recommends to any person that any financial product is a suitable investment or that returns are guaranteed. Because of this, you should consider your own objectives, financial situation and if the advice relates to the acquisition, or possible acquisition, of a particular financial product. Certifications are current for 24 months and subject to change at any time.

Socially Conscious diversified investment options

High Growth Socially Conscious

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a strong focus on growth assets such as shares and private equity. This option excludes or restricts investments we consider to have a highly adverse environmental or social impact. *

Who might invest in this option?

Members looking to maximise their long-term growth while also seeking to invest in a socially-conscious way. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 4.00% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	28.5%	18-39%
International shares	38.5%	28-49%
Private equity	6.5%	0-27%
Infrastructure	10.4%	0-32%
Property	6.5%	0-27%
Credit income	2.9%	0-24%
Fixed income	0%	0-10%
Cash	6.7%	0-15%

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	86%
Defensive assets	14%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	4 to less than 6
Short-term risk (market volatility):	6 - High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	2 - Low

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
-	-	11.73% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.36%
Transaction costs:	0.07%

Balanced Socially Conscious

Summary

Invests in a wide range of assets with a focus on growth assets such as shares and private equity. This option excludes or restricts investments we consider to have a highly adverse environmental or social impact. *

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking strong long-term returns who also want to invest in a socially-conscious way. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 3.75% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	23%	13-33%
International shares	32%	22-42%
Private equity	5%	0-26%
Infrastructure	10.9%	0-32%
Property	6.5%	0-27%
Credit income	5.9%	0-27%
Fixed income	10%	0-25%
Cash	6.7%	0-45%

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	73%
Defensive assets	27%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

7 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	3 to less than 4
Short-term risk (market volatility):	5 - Medium to High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	2 - Low

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
8.78% p.a	7.76% p.a	10.56% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.31%
Transaction costs:	0.07%

* See 'Responsible Investment Association Australasia certification' on page 22 for more information.

Indexed diversified investment options

These are simple, low cost options that invest in shares, fixed income and cash only. These asset classes are passively managed by one external manager (except cash which is actively managed in-house).

High Growth Indexed

Summary

Invests in a range of passively managed assets with a strong focus on growth assets such as Australian and international shares.

Who might invest in this option?

Members looking to maximise long-term growth via a low-cost diversified option. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 3.25% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares[1]	39%	29-49%
International shares[1]	51%	41-61%
Listed property	0%	0-10%
Fixed income	7%	0-17%
Cash	3%	0-15%

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	90%
Defensive assets	10%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	4 to less than 6
Short-term risk (market volatility):	6 - High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	2 - Low

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
-	-	13.19% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.05%
Transaction costs:	0.01%

Balanced Indexed

Summary

Invests in a range of passively managed assets with a focus on growth assets such as Australian and international shares.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking strong long-term returns via a low-cost diversified option. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

CPI + 3.00% p.a. over rolling 10-year periods after investment fees and costs, and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares[1]	31%	21-41%
International shares[1]	44%	34-54%
Listed property	0%	0-10%
Fixed income	20%	0-35%
Cash	5%	0-45%

Growth/defensive target	
Growth assets	75%
Defensive assets	25%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

7 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	4 to less than 6
Short-term risk (market volatility):	6 - High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	3 - Low to Medium

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
-	-	11.77% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.05%
Transaction costs:	0.01%

1 These asset classes are managed to custom MSCI indexes which adjust company weights based on carbon-transition metrics and apply Aware Super's fund-wide investment restrictions. For more details, see 'Custom share indexes' on page 33.

Returns at market extremes will generally be greater (positive and negative) for the Indexed options compared to the equivalent Core and Socially Conscious options. This is because they are less diversified (by asset class, investment style and investment manager).

Single asset class investment options

Australian Shares

Summary

Invests in a portfolio of companies listed on the Australian Securities Exchange (ASX). This option is passively managed meaning it will closely match the benchmark.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking strong long-term returns from a low-cost exposure to Australian shares. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

To track the return of the Aware Super Custom Index on MSCI Australia Shares 300[1], before fees, costs and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian shares	100%	95-100%
Cash	0%	0-5%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	6 or greater
Short-term risk (market volatility):	7 - Very High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	3 - Low to Medium

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
9.66% p.a	8.07% p.a	10.68% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.05%
Transaction costs:	0.00%

International Shares

Summary

Invests in a portfolio of companies listed on global stock exchanges in developed markets. This option is passively managed, meaning it will closely match the benchmark, and unhedged so will fluctuate due to both changes in share prices and currency movements.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking strong long-term returns from a low-cost exposure to global shares. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

To track the return of the Aware Super Custom Index on MSCI World ex-Australia[1] (AUD), before fees, costs and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
International shares	100%	95-100%
Cash	0%	0-5%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	6 or greater
Short-term risk (market volatility):	7 - Very High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	3 - Low to Medium

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
13.24% p.a	12.55% p.a	16.97% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.05%
Transaction costs:	0.00%

1 A custom index that adjusts company weights based on carbon-transition metrics and applies Aware Super's investment restrictions. For more details, see 'Custom share indexes' on page 33.

Single asset class investment options (continued)

Property

Summary

Invests in a portfolio of property securities listed on global stock exchanges. This option is passively managed, meaning it will closely match the benchmark, and its international investments are usually fully hedged so are protected against the impact of currency fluctuations.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking strong long-term returns from a low-cost exposure to global property. Best suited to members with a long-term investment horizon who are comfortable with significant fluctuations in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

To track the return of the FTSE EPRA/NAREIT Developed Rental Index Net Dividends Reinvested (AUD hedged), before fees, costs and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Listed property	100%	95-100%
Cash	0%	0-5%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

10 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	6 or greater
Short-term risk (market volatility):	7 - Very High
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	5 - Medium to High

Past performance[1]

10 years	5 years	3 years
5.95% p.a	4.22% p.a	8.60% p.a

Estimated fees and costs[1]

Investment fees and costs:	0.13%
Transaction costs:	0.01%

Bonds

Summary

Invests in a portfolio of Australian and international fixed income assets such as government and corporate bonds. This option is passively managed, meaning it will closely match the benchmark, and its international investments are usually fully hedged so are protected against the impact of currency fluctuations.

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking relatively stable but modest returns from a low-cost exposure to bonds. Suited to members with a medium-term investment horizon who are willing to accept some fluctuation in the value of their investments.

Investment objective

To track the returns of a weighted index: 50% to the Bloomberg AusBond Composite 0+ Yr Index and 50% to the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Index (AUD hedged), before fees, costs and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target	Range
Australian fixed income	50%	0-100%
International fixed income	50%	0-100%
Cash	0%	0-5%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

5 years

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	1 to less than 2
Short-term risk (market volatility):	3 - Low to Medium
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	7 - Very High

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
-	-	3.34% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.06%
Transaction costs:	0.00%

1 The Property option has been fully invested in listed property since 31 December 2022. Prior to this date, it held a mix of listed and unlisted property. Returns over five and ten years reflect the performance of both the previous and current investment strategies. Fees and costs include performance fees no longer incurred (see also 'Additional explanation of fees and costs' from page 41).

Did you know?

- Like shares, listed property securities trade on public markets. Listed property returns will therefore differ to those from unlisted property and are typically more volatile.
- Bonds are a defensive asset as most of their return tends to come from income rather than capital growth. While this means returns are typically more stable, it does not mean they will always be positive.

Single asset class investment options (continued)

Cash

Summary

Currently invests in term deposits and other short-term interest-bearing investments. The option may also invest in interest-bearing accounts with authorised deposit-taking institutions (ADIs) such as banks.[1] This option is not covered by the Government Guarantee (Financial Claims Scheme).

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking a very low risk short-term investment with stable but low expected returns. You should be aware that the return you receive may not keep pace with inflation.

Investment objective

To meet or exceed the return of the Bloomberg AusBond Bank Bill Index, over rolling 12-month periods, before fees, costs and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target
Cash	100%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

Up to 2 years

Minimum investment amount

-

Maximum investment amount

-

Minimum account balance

-

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	Less than 0.5
Short-term risk (market volatility):	1 - Very Low
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	7 - Very High

Past performance

10 years	5 years	3 years
2.33% p.a	3.16% p.a	4.14% p.a

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.03%
Transaction costs:	0.00%

Term Deposit

Summary

A non-unitised option that allows members to invest directly in bank term deposits. Note this option is not covered by the Government Guarantee (Financial Claims Scheme).

Who might invest in this option?

Members seeking a fixed rate of return for locking away funds for a set period of time to help plan for short to medium-term cash flow needs. You should be aware that once funds are invested in a term deposit, you will not be able to switch or withdraw those funds until the term deposit matures. In addition, depending on prevailing interest rates, the return you receive may not keep pace with inflation.

Investment objective

To exceed the returns of the Bloomberg AusBond Bank Bill Index, over rolling 12-month periods, before fees, costs and tax.

Asset allocation



Asset class	Target
Cash	100%

Minimum suggested investment timeframe

Members can choose a 3, 6, 9 or 12-month investment timeframe

Minimum investment amount

$5,000

Maximum investment amount

$5 million

Minimum account balance

$15,000 (excluding any amounts already invested in the Term Deposit option)

Risk

Estimated number of negative annual returns over any 20-year period:	Less than 0.5
Short-term risk (market volatility):	1 - Very Low
Long-term risk (insufficient returns):	7 - Very High

Past performance

The return you receive will depend on the term chosen and the interest rate available at the time your term deposit is processed. Indicative term deposit rates are available at **aware.com.au/termdeposit**.

Estimated fees and costs

Investment fees and costs:	0.00%
Transaction costs:	0.00%

You should read the important information on the following page before making a decision regarding the Term Deposit option.

1 Details of any ADIs used by the option and the proportion invested with each ADI are available at **aware.com.au/cash**.



About the Term Deposit option

How the Term Deposit option works

The Term Deposit option is a non-unitised investment option that provides a fixed rate of return in exchange for locking away funds for a term of 3, 6, 9, or 12 months.[1] The latest indicative term deposit rates are available at **aware.com.au/termdeposit**.

Each term deposit you hold must be a minimum of $5,000 and a maximum of $5 million.

To invest in a term deposit, you must have a minimum account balance of $15,000 (excluding any amounts already in the Term Deposit option), and keep the greater of $10,000 or 10% of your account balance invested in options other than Term Deposit – this is because fees, costs and other deductions cannot be withdrawn from funds in the Term Deposit option.

You can apply for a term deposit on any day, provided you have no other term deposit application, maturity, or change of investment options pending. Once you submit an application for a term deposit, it cannot be cancelled.

Funds invested in a term deposit generally cannot be moved or withdrawn until maturity when they have been transferred to the Cash investment option.

Processing timeframe

- Applications for term deposits received before 3:00pm AEST/AEDT on a business day will generally be processed using the applicable rate for that day.
- Applications submitted after 3:00pm on a business day, or on a weekend or public holiday, are treated as having been received on the next business day.
- Applications submitted after 3:00pm on a Friday will generally be processed using the rates applicable for the following week.

When your term deposit reaches maturity, your investment (including interest earned) will automatically be transferred to the Cash investment option.

1 The maturity date may not be exactly 3, 6, 9 or 12 months after the start date due to weekends and public holidays falling during the investment term.

Term Deposit rates

The Term Deposit option offers a fixed interest rate for the term selected. Once your term deposit is established, the rate is locked in for the entire term.

Term deposit rates are set by the term deposit provider and are reviewed and updated on a regular basis.

Indicative rates are generally published for business days Monday to Friday and are available at **aware.com.au/termdeposit**

The interest rate applied to your investment is the rate available when your term deposit is processed.

The rate you receive may differ from the indicative rate shown at the time you apply.

Early termination

Early termination of a term deposit before its maturity date is subject to our discretion (as trustee) and we retain the right not to allow a term deposit to be terminated early.

An interest adjustment in the form of a reduction in accrued interest may apply where a term deposit is terminated before maturity. However, we will generally allow early termination of a term deposit without an interest adjustment in the following circumstances:

- Death
- Terminal illness
- Total and permanent disability
- Permanent incapacity
- Financial hardship, or
- Compassionate grounds (as determined by the ATO).

Rollovers

A term deposit is an illiquid investment since it requires an investment for a fixed term. As a result, if you have a term deposit investment and request a rollover or transfer of a benefit in full to another fund, we may not be able to process it within the 30-day period ordinarily required under superannuation legislation. Instead, the portion of your account balance in investment options other than the Term Deposit option, minus $6,000 (to cover the administration fee, account-keeping fee and insurance premiums) will generally be transferred to another fund nominated within three business days. The remainder of your account balance will be transferred within the three business days of maturity of the relevant term deposit(s).

Other important information

When investing in a term deposit, it is important you also understand the following rules and restrictions:

- If there are insufficient funds in an investment option from which you have elected to withdraw money to invest in a term deposit, the remaining required funds will be withdrawn from the investment option with the highest available balance.
- If there are insufficient funds in your account to cover a term deposit application (e.g. due to a drop in the value of the account between the date of application and the date the term deposit becomes effective), the term deposit application will not be approved.
- If we receive a term deposit application and a change of investment option request on the same day, the term deposit application will be processed first, unless you provide us with clear instructions to do otherwise. This means your request to change investment options will not be processed until the term deposit application has been finalised, which generally takes three business days.

Other important investment information

This section contains important information you should also consider when choosing an investment option.

This includes:

- how we partner with investment managers
- the difference between active and passive management
- our Responsible Ownership approach
- our custom share indexes
- how we manage foreign currency, and
- how we use derivatives.

Investment managers

We engage a number of leading Australian and international investment managers to invest on our behalf. The Aware Super Investment team also manages a range of investments in-house. This combination of internal and external management means we can offer a more diversified mix of investment strategies and use our economies of scale to help lower costs.

Active vs passive management

For our Core and Socially Conscious investment options we actively manage investments where we believe this can enhance returns. The Indexed diversified and single asset class options use passive management only so are a lower cost alternative.

Active management

Active managers select investments that they believe will perform better than a market benchmark over the long term. They employ an experienced team of portfolio managers and researchers and buy or sell investments when their market outlook or investment insights change.

Passive management

Also known as index managers, passive managers choose a portfolio of investments that closely tracks a market benchmark (or index). Passive managers usually charge lower fees because they don't need extensive resources to select investments.

Responsible Ownership

We integrate environmental, social and governance (ESG) considerations into our investment processes. Known as Responsible Ownership, this approach helps us better manage risk and generate strong long-term returns for our members. ESG factors may include labour standards and environmental, social and ethical considerations. This section describes which of these factors we consider and the extent to which we take them into account.

Our Responsible Ownership approach is fund-wide and applies to all investment options, though how it applies can vary depending on an option's mix of asset classes and investment styles. For some investment options, only some aspects may apply.

Our Responsible Ownership approach consists of four main focus areas as outlined below. This multifaceted approach helps us identify emerging ESG risks and issues and respond appropriately.

1: ESG integration

Our approach is not limited to a set-and-forget analysis of an investment, but rather is a holistic approach to assessing ESG risks and opportunities over an investment's life. This means we consider ESG factors in our asset and manager due diligence when we first invest and continue this through our ongoing monitoring.

Other than our fund-wide investment restrictions (see '4: Investment restrictions' from page 32), we do not follow a pre-determined methodology for weighting different ESG considerations in assessing whether an investment is suitable. Rather, we consider the relative importance of ESG factors on a case-by-case basis.

When we're considering partnering with an external investment manager, we assess their ESG capabilities and policies as appropriate to the investment type and style. We also regularly meet with them to review their ESG integration approach and discuss how they are monitoring ESG risks and issues. We expect our investment managers to monitor ESG risks relating to our investments, though allow them some flexibility to determine how they implement ESG considerations subject to the restrictions set out in '4: Investment restrictions'.

Here are some examples of key ESG factors we consider in our investment process:

Environmental factors	• Climate change mitigation and adaptation • Waste, pollution and contamination • Water (e.g. availability and supply) • Biodiversity and sustainable land use
Social factors	• Workplace health and safety • Diversity and inclusion • Adherence to international conventions • Modern slavery/forced labour (both in company operations and supply chains) • The effectiveness of a company in maintaining its 'licence to operate' and managing labour relations • Product responsibility
Governance factors	• Board composition (diversity, expertise and independence) • Executive remuneration • Transparency and reporting • Conduct and culture • Technology and innovation • Data privacy and cyber security

We may take into account other ESG factors if they apply to a particular investment or investment manager. Our investment process applies to investments on which we directly undertake due diligence. Where investment managers take into account ESG considerations, they may consider different ESG factors.

2: Advocacy and collaboration

We believe we can have a greater impact by working alongside other like-minded investors and industry associations. This means we will, to the extent we consider it appropriate, share our insights into ESG issues and their potential investment impact with other investors. However, we do not rely on those other investors to make investment decisions for us.

We are a signatory to the Principles for Responsible Investment and are involved in a number of collaborative initiatives including the Australian Council of Superannuation Investors, Responsible Investment Association Australasia and Climate Action 100+.

Collaborating with other large investors in these initiatives helps us understand the risks and opportunities of ESG issues across a range of industries and sectors.

3: Stewardship: Engagement and voting

Engagement

We monitor ESG considerations and when we identify a material risk or issue we will often use our ownership rights to engage with the company. This is particularly important if we believe its management of ESG issues is falling short of government/regulator or industry standards and/or community expectations, or its conduct threatens its reputation and value.

The objective of engagement is to encourage the company to improve its ESG policies and practices, and thereby protect or increase its economic value. A typical engagement can take between one and three years to complete and may require multiple engagements before an issue is satisfactorily resolved. If our engagement doesn't produce a favourable outcome within a reasonable timeframe, we may consider other actions such as voting against directors or raising a shareholder proposal. However, we can't guarantee that action taken by us in connection with any ESG issues will result in the desired change, and we may continue to hold the relevant investment.

Voting

As a large investor we own shares in a diverse range of companies which entitles us to vote on various matters. In general we use our voting rights to support resolutions that we believe will enhance value for our members across a range of areas such as board composition, executive remuneration, and climate-related disclosure and action. You can find information on our voting decisions at **aware.com.au/proxyvoting**.

Where applicable, we expect external and internal investment managers to consider their position on company resolutions, but the trustee has the right to any final voting decision and can override a manager's vote.

4: Investment restrictions

We have implemented the below fund-wide restrictions[1] subject to the notes explained in this section:

Restriction	Description
Tobacco	Direct investments in tobacco manufacturers and/or producers which derive 5% or more of their revenue from the manufacture and/or production of tobacco products.
Thermal coal	Direct investments in companies that generate 10% or more of their revenues directly from mining thermal or energy coal.
Controversial weapons	Direct investments in companies verifiably involved[2] in the manufacture and/or production of anti-personnel mines, biological weapons, chemical weapons, cluster munitions, depleted uranium, incendiary weapons and white phosphorous weapons (whole systems or key components[3]).
	Direct investments in companies verifiably involved[2] in, and deriving 5% or more revenue from, the manufacture and/or production of nuclear weapons (whole systems or key components[3]).

1 The fund-wide restrictions differ from those in the Socially Conscious options. Restrictions and exclusions in the Socially Conscious options are broader and apply to all assets (except derivatives, securitised assets and non-cash collateral), and the revenue thresholds for tobacco, thermal coal and nuclear weapons are lower (i.e. stricter). See 'Socially Conscious diversified investment options' from page 20 for more information.
2 For directly held liquid investments such as shares and bonds, this verification is undertaken by our ESG data provider ISS STOXX. For unlisted direct investments, an internal assessment is made.
3 A component is a key component if it plays an essential role in the functionality of the specified weapon system or is specifically designed or modified for the specified weapons.

Please note:

- Our investment options may have an indirect exposure to companies involved in these activities because the fund-wide restrictions don't apply to indirect exposures. This includes derivatives, exchange-traded products such as ETFs, securitised assets (financial products that give the holder exposure to a pool of loans, bonds or other debt products), non-cash collateral held under the fund's securities lending program, and investment vehicles governed by an uncontrolled entity including unit trusts and fund of funds via pooled vehicles.
- The trustee may acquire an interest in assets we would otherwise seek to restrict or exclude as a result of a merger with another super fund. If this occurs, the relevant assets will be sold at fair value as soon as reasonably practicable.
- We do not exclude companies that provide goods or services to entities generating revenue from tobacco products, thermal coal or controversial weapons, or that are involved in the distribution or deployment of these items.
- We rely on data provided by ISS STOXX to apply the fund-wide restrictions for directly held liquid investments such as shares and bonds.#
- Implementation of these restrictions may be affected by the accessibility and accuracy of data, a merger, or external service provider errors. This may result in inadvertent holdings, typically over the short term, in investments we are seeking to exclude. If this occurs, we will endeavour to divest as soon as reasonably practicable.
- We do not automatically exclude companies' subsidiaries, joint ventures or bond issuers; each is assessed on its own verifiable involvement in the relevant activity. For example, if a company is excluded due to its involvement in controversial weapons, its subsidiary will only be excluded if it is assessed to be verifiably involved in controversial weapons based on its own activities.

We may divest from other sectors, industries or investments without prior notice, in line with our Responsible Ownership Policy, as updated from time to time.

For more information, you can read our Responsible Ownership Policy, available at **aware.com.au/responsiblesuper**

We measure the positive impacts of some of our unlisted assets on people and the environment, and have established frameworks for this purpose. To learn more and see examples, refer to our Responsible Investment Report, available at **aware.com.au/annualreport**.

Climate change

We believe climate change is one of the most significant long-term risks to our portfolio, and therefore our members' retirement outcomes. We have undertaken significant research and work to establish a climate strategy to help manage this risk in our investment portfolios. For more information go to our website at **aware.com.au/climatechange**

For more information on ISS STOXX's methodology, see their website at **issgovernance.com/esg/methodology-information/**. The most relevant documents include the 'Energy & Extractives Screening', 'Controversial Weapons Research' and 'Sector-Based Screening' methodology and research process papers. This information is accurate as at the date of this *Handbook*, however ISS STOXX may update their website from time to time.

Custom share indexes

Some of our passive and systematic Australian and international share portfolios are managed to custom indexes developed in collaboration with MSCI. The indexes support our goal to reduce the financed emissions intensity[1] in our listed share portfolios by 45% by 2030 compared with 30 June 2020 levels (Target Emissions).

Our Australian shares indexes are based on the MSCI Australia Listed 300 or MSCI Australia Listed 200 Index as relevant, and our international shares indexes are based on either the MSCI World ex Australia Index or the MSCI All Country World Index ex Australia (together, the Base Indexes).

MSCI customises the Base Indexes using a carbon-transition metric that assesses each company's current and expected future financed emissions.[2] This process is applied in two stages: first, companies are screened based on their potential emissions associated with their fossil fuel reserves; second, their estimated 2030 emissions are assessed taking into account transition plans, expected emissions reduction pathways and for energy producers, fossil fuel reserves estimates. Companies with a higher carbon-transition metric are excluded or assigned a lower weighting in the index, while other companies are added to help maintain diversification.[3] These changes help move the share portfolios towards achieving the Target Emissions by 2030.

Finally, the indexes also apply our fund-wide investment restrictions of tobacco, thermal coal and controversial weapons by excluding companies that derive revenue from these activities (subject to applicable materiality thresholds).[4]

We review the indexes quarterly with MSCI and rebalance the portfolios as needed to reflect any changes.

Foreign currency management

The returns from overseas investments such as international shares or bonds reflect both changes in the value of the investments and currency movements. A higher Australian dollar can reduce returns on international investments, while a lower Australian dollar can improve returns.

Currency hedging can be used to protect Australian investors against these currency movements. This can reduce a potential loss from unfavourable currency movements, but it can also reduce a potential profit.

We set a strategic currency exposure for each diversified investment option and use currency hedging to achieve the target. Currency exposures are published periodically at **aware.com.au/assetallocations**. These amounts indicate the proportion of the option's assets affected by foreign currency movements.

Use of derivatives

A derivative is a financial instrument whose value depends on, or is derived from, another source such as an asset, market index or interest rate. We may use a range of derivatives including forwards, futures, options and swaps to:

- manage risk (e.g. foreign currency hedging)
- facilitate asset allocation
- implement investment positions efficiently, and
- enhance returns.

Holding derivatives can give rise to both gains and losses. Favourable price movements in the underlying asset can generate gains, while unfavourable price movements can result in losses.

We have an internal policy in place to ensure our Investment team and external investment managers use derivatives appropriately and operate within specific guidelines.

1 Financed emissions reflect the greenhouse gas emissions associated with investments held in the portfolio, based on Aware Super's proportional ownership or share of financing. For this goal, financed emissions include Scope 1 and 2 emissions. Financed emissions intensity measures those emissions relative to the value of the investments, allowing emissions levels to be compared over time and across portfolios.

2 For information on MSCI's sustainability and climate methodologies, visit **msci.com/legal/sustainability-and-climate-resources-and-disclosures/msci-sustainability-and-climate-methodologies**. Key documents include 'MSCI Greenhouse Gas Emissions Methodologies', 'MSCI Fossil Fuels and Power Generation Metrics' and 'MSCI Implied Temperature Rise Methodology'.

3 Companies added into the indexes are from the relevant broader investable market index, including smaller listed companies.

4 For more details, including the materiality thresholds, see '4: Investment restrictions' from page 32.

Valuations and unit pricing

Valuation of the fund's assets

We value our investments regularly so we can process transactions at values that are fair and reasonable. Some investments such as shares, fixed income and cash are valued daily, while others are valued less frequently.

Listed investments such as shares are valued using the end-of-day price quoted on the relevant exchange, for example the ASX. Fixed income securities such as bonds, which are not traded on listed markets, are valued using market average prices from independent sources.

Investments in unlisted property and infrastructure, private equity and some hedge funds are valued less frequently – typically quarterly or monthly – but at least twice a year. We use registered valuers or pre-determined methods for these valuations.

Unit prices

The money you invest with us is pooled with other members' savings and invested to earn you a return. This allows access to a wider range of investments.

Your account is invested in one or more investment options.[1] Other than the Term Deposit option, the investment options are unit-based. This means when you add money to your super, you purchase units in your chosen investment option(s). When you withdraw money, or when fees and costs are deducted from your account, you sell units. The value of your account is based on the number of units and unit value of each investment option you hold.

Each business day we calculate the unit price of each unit-based option. The value of your account balance will fluctuate depending on variations in the unit price of your investment option(s) and the amount of any fees and charges applied to your account. If the investment option earns positive returns, both the unit price and the value of your investment rise. If the investment option experiences negative returns, the unit price and the value of your investment both fall.

We may temporarily suspend or delay unit pricing if extreme market volatility or circumstances outside of our control mean we can't calculate a fair unit price. If we need to delay or suspend a unit price for any or all investment options, we may stop processing transactions until a unit price is available. The delay or suspension could be for some time and we aren't responsible for any losses that delayed or suspended transactions may cause. If we delay or suspend unit prices we will let you know on our website at **aware.com.au/unitprices**

Each investment option's unit price is published the following business day, generally after 6pm. For the latest unit prices go to **aware.com.au/unitprices**

How are unit prices calculated?

The unit price for each investment option is calculated by dividing the value of the assets in the option (after allowing for fees, costs and taxes) by the number of units on issue.



1 Aware Super Future Saver – NSW Police Officers and Aware Super Future Saver – Ambulance Officers compulsory insurance accounts are maintained only to provide insurance cover and are not invested in any investment option.



Changing investment options

You can change (switch) investment options at any time. Find out how to make a switch and what to consider before you do.

What to consider before you switch investment options

Changing your investments is one of the biggest decisions you can make about your super. Ask these questions to make sure you're ready to make the switch.

Is this the right time to change investment options?

All investors seek to buy at a low price and sell at a high price. If you switch your investments after they fall in value, however, you could be selling them when they're at a low price and locking in a loss. Markets are hard to predict. If you switch into a more conservative option when markets fall and don't switch back until after markets rebound, you will miss the early gains (which are often the strongest) and may buy back at a high price.

What's your timeframe?

Think about your investment timeframe and the future impact of making a change. Super is generally a long-term investment. This means the investment option(s) you choose can have a big impact on the balance you retire with. Investing too conservatively can actually be risky because over the long term your investment may not earn a return above the inflation rate. If your super grows at a rate lower than inflation, you could be losing money without realising it.

Are you approaching retirement?

Switching to a lower risk investment option can be appealing to those close to retirement who have less time to recover from market losses. However, even if you've stopped working, your savings could remain invested for another 30 years. Around 30% of the income paid from your retirement income account could come from the returns you make in retirement.[1] By sticking to your long-term goals, you could benefit from a lot of growth even after you stop working.

1 Source: Aware Super modelling, August 2025. For more information, including a list of assumptions, go to **aware.com.au/retirementcasestudy**

Do you need to diversify your investments?

Investing in a range of asset classes, investment styles, managers and geographical regions reduces risk in a portfolio. That's because if any one of these falls in value, another might make up for this loss.

Do you need help?

Don't feel you have to make these decisions alone. We can help you work through all the questions you need to consider, before you change how your super's invested. Call us on **1300 650 873** to speak to a super consultant or make an appointment to see one of our financial planners.

Switching your investment options

You can switch the investment options for your current account balance or future contributions, or opt in to MySuper Lifecycle at any time, as long as you don't have an investment switch or term deposit application pending.

You can switch by logging into Member Online or by contacting us.

If we receive a valid request from you to switch investment options by 3pm AEST/AEDT on a business day, we will normally process it using the unit prices that apply for that day (generally determined by 6pm the next day). If we don't have enough information from you to process your request, we may use a later unit price.

A business day means all weekdays excluding the following public holidays: New Year's Day, Australia Day, Good Friday, Easter Monday, ANZAC Day (when it falls on a weekday), King's Birthday, Christmas Day and Boxing Day.

Cancelling a switch

Once you've submitted a switch request or a term deposit application, you cannot cancel it. In addition, you won't be able to submit any other change requests until we've processed your initial request, which typically takes about three business days.

Changes to future contributions

You can make a change to how your future contributions are invested independently of a switch for your current investments.

Rebalancing your investment options

If you invest in one of our diversified options, we regularly monitor the asset allocation and take care of rebalancing for you. If you're invested in more than one investment option, the percentage of your account balance in each option will change over time as a result of market movements which could change the risk profile of your account. As a result, you may want to rebalance your account periodically to bring the percentage invested in each option back in line with your original selection. This involves switching a portion of your account balance from one option to another.

When you rebalance your account, you may be moving money from options that have performed well to options that have performed less well. While this may seem counterintuitive, it's important to remember it can be risky to rely too heavily on any one asset class, and the asset class or investment option with the highest returns one year may not perform as well the next year.

Automatic rebalancing feature

We offer a rebalancing feature which automatically realigns your account balance with your chosen mix of investment options on 15 July each year.[1]

You can opt in for automatic rebalancing at the time you set up your account, or by logging in to Member Online.

The Term Deposit investment option is excluded from the rebalancing feature. If you hold a term deposit on 15 July and you have elected to rebalance your account, it won't be included in your rebalance.

Note: The rebalancing feature is based on percentages. If you perform a dollar-based switch after opting in to the rebalancing feature, the rebalancing feature you have in place will be cancelled.

Please read all of the information in this *Handbook* before making an investment switch decision. You should choose investment options to suit your personal objectives, financial situation and needs, and consider seeking advice from a financial planner before you choose or change your investment option(s).

1 If 15 July does not fall on a business day, the rebalance will be processed on the next business day.

Understanding your fees and costs

Fees help cover the cost of managing your super and providing products and services to support your retirement savings. Here's a plain-English guide to the different types of fees and costs.

For a more detailed explanation, including the amounts that may apply for each of these fee types, see page 39, or the 'Additional explanation of fees and costs' section starting on page 41.

Type of fee or cost		What it is
Standard fees and costs These are ongoing account fees and costs that apply to all members.	**Administration fees and costs** These cover the essential day-to-day costs of running the fund. There are three components of Administration fees and costs, but only the first two are deducted from member accounts.	**Account-keeping fee** A fixed dollar fee charged to each account regardless of balance. **Administration fee** A variable fee calculated as a percentage of your account balance. This fee has a cap. Once your balance reaches a certain level, your variable administration fee won't go any higher — even if your balance keeps growing. **Administration costs paid from fund reserves** In some years, it costs more to run the fund than is collected in administration fees. When this happens, fund reserves may be used to cover the gap. These amounts are not deducted from your account balance.
	Investment-related fees and costs These aren't deducted directly from your account. Instead, they're reflected in the unit price of the investment option, meaning investment returns are shown after fees have been taken into account.	**Investment fees and costs** These amounts cover what it costs Aware Super to professionally manage the investments in your chosen option(s). **Transaction costs** Transaction costs reflect the costs incurred when buying, selling and researching investments.
Other fees and costs These fees only apply if you choose to use one of these optional features or services.	**Member activity-related fees**	**Advice fees** General advice about your account (phone or video) is included at no extra cost. For more personal, comprehensive advice, we offer a fee-for-service option — which is a cost agreed to upfront and can be deducted from your account. **Insurance costs** If you hold insurance through your account, you'll only pay what it costs Aware Super to provide and administer your cover (this equals the insurance premium charged by the insurer + the insurance administration fee charged by us).

Did you know?

Government taxes may apply to your super contributions. These taxes are set by the government and are separate from Aware Super's fees and costs. Check your transactions in Member Online, or your statements for the taxes you've paid.



Fees and other costs

The wording on this page is required by law. Our fees and costs are not negotiable.

Did you know?

Small differences in both investment performance and fees and costs can have a substantial impact on your long-term returns.

For example, total annual fees and costs of 2% of your account balance rather than 1% could reduce your final return by up to 20% over a 30-year period (for example, reduce it from $100,000 to $80,000).

You should consider whether features such as superior investment performance or the provision of better member services justify higher fees and costs.

You or your employer, as applicable, may be able to negotiate to pay lower fees. Ask the fund or your financial adviser.

To find out more

If you would like to find out more, or see the impact of the fees based on your own circumstances, the **Australian Securities and Investments Commission (ASIC)** Moneysmart website (**www.moneysmart.gov.au**) has a superannuation calculator to help you check out different fee options.

This section shows fees and other costs that you may be charged. These fees and other costs may be deducted from your money, from the returns on your investment, or from the assets of the superannuation entity as a whole.

Other fees, such as activity fees, advice fees for personal advice and insurance fees, may also be charged, but these will depend on the nature of the activity, advice or insurance chosen by you. Entry fees and exit fees cannot be charged.

Taxes, insurance fees and other costs relating to insurance are set out in another part of this document.

You should read all the information about fees and other costs because it is important to understand their impact on your investment.

The fees and other costs for the MySuper product offered by the superannuation entity, and each investment option offered by the entity are set out on page 41.

Fees and costs summary - Aware Super Future Saver

Type of fee or cost	Amount	How and when paid
Ongoing annual fees and costs[1, 2]		
Administration fees and costs	Account-keeping fee of $52 per year[3] *plus* Administration fee of 0.15% per year ($75 per $50,000), capped at $62.50 per month *plus* Costs paid from reserves of 0.03% for the 2025/26 financial year.	We calculate the account keeping fee daily and deduct it from your account at the end of each month and on exit from the fund. We calculate the administration fee monthly based on your account balance at the end of the month and deduct it from your account at the end of each month and on exit from the fund. Administration costs paid from reserves that are not otherwise charged as administration fees. These costs are not directly charged to your account but have reduced the administration reserve balance held by the fund to cover future administration and operating costs.
Investment fees and costs[4, 5]	**MySuper Lifecycle approach**, estimated to range from 0.38% to 0.44% per year ($190 to $220 per $50,000). **All other investment options**, estimated to range from 0.00% to 0.44% per year ($0 to $220 per $50,000). The amount you pay varies according to which option(s) you select. See the table in 'Additional explanation of fees and costs' for more information.	Deducted from the income or assets of the relevant option or an underlying investment vehicle before daily unit prices are calculated.
Transaction costs[4]	**MySuper Lifecycle approach**, estimated to range from 0.07% to 0.08% per year ($35 to $40 per $50,000). **All other investment options**, estimated to range from 0.00% to 0.08% per year ($0 to $40 per $50,000). The amount you pay varies according to which option(s) you select. See the table in 'Additional explanation of fees and costs' for more information.	Incurred over the course of the year and deducted from the assets of the relevant option or an underlying investment vehicle before daily unit prices are calculated.
Member activity related fees and costs		
Buy-sell spread	Nil	Not charged
Switching fee	Nil	Not charged
Other fees and cost[6]	**Advice fees** $0 for intra-fund advice	We don't charge an advice fee for intra-fund advice about your Aware Super account. This applies to all members investing in any MySuper Lifecycle stage or investment option.
	Broader and more complex personal advice	As trustee, we may deduct a fee from your account for personal financial product advice provided by your financial planner solely in respect of your account (this excludes advice which is not about your account e.g. about your non-super investments). This will only occur where you have authorised us to pay the fees and we have entered into an agreement with your financial planner's licensee which requires us to pay the fee.
	Insurance costs The cost of insurance cover includes the insurance premium charged by the insurer, and any insurance administration fee charged by us. Details of each of these costs are set out below: • **Insurance premiums** Insurance premiums can be based on a range of factors including age, cover type and amount, and your insurance category. • **Insurance administration fee** We charge an insurance administration fee of $1.85 per month.	Your employer may cover some or all of your insurance costs. You should read the *Insurance Handbook* relevant to you for more information. We calculate insurance premiums daily and we will generally deduct them from your account at the end of each month. If your insurance starts, ends, increases or decreases during a month, we'll charge a pro-rata premium based on the number of days you were covered in that month. If you withdraw all your money from your account, we deduct any unpaid premiums and fees before paying you the balance. If you have any insurance on the last day of the month, the insurance administration fee is deducted from your account. This fee won't be charged for the first 60 days if you only hold insurance that was issued to you automatically. See the *Insurance Handbook* relevant to you for details.

1 If your account balance for a product offered by the superannuation entity is less than $6,000 at the end of the entity's income year, certain fees and costs charged to you in relation to administration and investment are capped at 3% of the account balance. Any amount charged in excess of that cap must be refunded.
2 Investment fees and costs and transaction costs are inclusive of GST and net of any reduced input tax credits (RITCs) at the prescribed rate. Administration fees and costs are not subject to GST.
3 Due to rounding of the monthly fee amounts the total account keeping fee will be $52.01 in some years.
4 These amounts are indicative only and are based on historical fee and cost data as at 30 June 2026. Past costs are not a reliable indicator of future costs. The amount you'll pay in future years will depend on the actual fees and costs incurred by the trustee in managing the investment option.
5 Investment fees and costs include an amount for performance fees, ranging from 0.00% to 0.14% depending on your investment option(s). The calculation basis for these amounts is set out under 'Additional explanation of fees and costs' from page 41.
6 See 'Additional explanation of fees and costs' from 41 for details.



Cost of product for 1 year

The wording on this page is required by law. We do not charge a buy-sell spread on any of our investment options.

The cost of product gives a summary calculation about how ongoing annual fees and costs can affect your superannuation investment over a 1-year period for all superannuation products and investment options. It is calculated in the manner shown in the 'Example of annual fees and costs' in the *Future Saver PDS*.

The cost of product information assumes a balance of $50,000 at the beginning of the year. (Additional fees such as a buy-sell spread may apply: refer to the 'Fees and costs summary' on page 39 for the relevant superannuation product or investment option.)

You should use this figure to help compare superannuation products and investment options.

Aware Super Future Saver	Cost of product
MySuper Lifecycle stages	
MySuper Lifecycle Grow – Age 55 and under	$402
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 56	$397
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 57	$392
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 58	$387
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 59	$387
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 60	$382
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 61	$377
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 62	$377
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 63	$372
MySuper Lifecycle Manage – Age 64	$372
MySuper Lifecycle Enjoy – Age 65 and over	$367

Aware Super Future Saver	Cost of product
Diversified investment options	
High Growth	$402
Balanced	$382
Conservative Balanced	$367
Conservative	$322
Defensive	$267
High Growth Socially Conscious	$357
Balanced Socially Conscious	$332
High Growth Indexed	$172
Balanced Indexed	$172
Single asset class investment options	
Australian Shares	$167
International Shares	$167
Property	$212
Bonds	$172
Cash	$157
Term Deposit	$142

Additional explanation of fees and costs

Ongoing annual fees and costs

The table below summarises the annual investment fees and costs and transaction costs for each investment option.

You should refer to our website at **aware.com.au/pdsupdates** for any updates to fees and costs which are not materially adverse. You can also call us on **1300 650 873** to request this information without charge.

Important: Investment fees and costs and transaction costs are not fixed and may vary from year to year. The amounts in the table below are indicative only. The amount you'll pay in future years will depend on the actual fees and costs incurred by the trustee in managing each investment option. **Past costs are not a reliable indicator of future costs.**

Lifecycle stage or investment option	Investment fees and costs		Total investment fees and costs	Transaction costs	Total investment fees and costs and transaction costs
	Investment base fees	Performance fees			
MySuper Lifecycle stages					
Grow – Age 55 and under	0.30%	0.14%	**0.44%**	0.08%	**0.52%**
Manage – Age 56	0.30%	0.13%	**0.43%**	0.08%	**0.51%**
Manage – Age 57	0.29%	0.14%	**0.43%**	0.07%	**0.50%**
Manage – Age 58	0.29%	0.13%	**0.42%**	0.07%	**0.49%**
Manage – Age 59	0.29%	0.12%	**0.41%**	0.08%	**0.49%**
Manage – Age 60	0.29%	0.11%	**0.40%**	0.08%	**0.48%**
Manage – Age 61	0.29%	0.11%	**0.40%**	0.07%	**0.47%**
Manage – Age 62	0.28%	0.12%	**0.40%**	0.07%	**0.47%**
Manage – Age 63	0.28%	0.11%	**0.39%**	0.07%	**0.46%**
Manage – Age 64	0.28%	0.11%	**0.39%**	0.07%	**0.46%**
Enjoy – Age 65 and over	0.28%	0.10%	**0.38%**	0.07%	**0.45%**
Diversified investment options					
High Growth	0.30%	0.14%	**0.44%**	0.08%	**0.52%**
Balanced	0.29%	0.11%	**0.40%**	0.08%	**0.48%**
Conservative Balanced	0.28%	0.10%	**0.38%**	0.07%	**0.45%**
Conservative	0.23%	0.08%	**0.31%**	0.05%	**0.36%**
Defensive	0.19%	0.03%	**0.22%**	0.03%	**0.25%**
High Growth Socially Conscious[1]	0.30%	0.06%	**0.36%**	0.07%	**0.43%**
Balanced Socially Conscious	0.28%	0.03%	**0.31%**	0.07%	**0.38%**
High Growth Indexed	0.05%	0.00%	**0.05%**	0.01%	**0.06%**
Balanced Indexed	0.05%	0.00%	**0.05%**	0.01%	**0.06%**
Single asset class investment options					
Australian Shares	0.05%	0.00%	**0.05%**	0.00%	**0.05%**
International Shares	0.05%	0.00%	**0.05%**	0.00%	**0.05%**
Property[2]	0.07%	0.06%	**0.13%**	0.01%	**0.14%**
Bonds	0.06%	0.00%	**0.06%**	0.00%	**0.06%**
Cash	0.03%	0.00%	**0.03%**	0.00%	**0.03%**
Term Deposit	0.00%	0.00%	**0.00%**	0.00%	**0.00%**

1 The High Growth Socially Conscious option commenced on 3 November 2022, so its performance fees are based on fees incurred from this date rather than a 5-year average.
2 The Property option no longer incurs performance fees. The fees shown in the table relate to unlisted property assets held before the option became fully invested in listed property on 31 December 2022.

Administration fees and costs

Administration fees and costs are charged by the trustee for administering and operating the fund.

Administration fees are paid into the fund's administration reserve and the fund pays its administration costs from that reserve. Any surplus in amounts paid into the administration reserve, together with credits from certain other sources (such as tax credits), are held in the administration reserve and may be used to fund administration and operating costs in subsequent years. This may include investment in strategic projects for the benefit of members.

The administration reserve is also used to fund the Operational Risk Financial Requirement (ORFR) reserve. Australian super funds are required to have an ORFR by the Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (APRA) to cover any losses, costs and expenses that may occur in the event of an operational risk event. Examples of operational risk events include systems failures, cyber security incidents, unit pricing errors and fraud.

If the administration-related costs paid from the administration reserve in any one year exceed the amounts paid into the reserve in that year, that excess amount is disclosed under 'Administration fees and costs' as an additional amount.

Part-month payments

a) Account-keeping fee
When you join or leave the fund part-way through a month, we pro-rata the account-keeping fee for the number of days you were in the fund, starting from the date of your first account transaction.

b) Administration fee
When you join the fund part-way through a month, we calculate the administration fee using your account balance at the end of the month, and pro-rata this amount for the number of days you were in the fund that month, starting from the date of your first account transaction.
When you leave the fund part-way through a month, we calculate the administration fee using your account balance at the time of processing your request, and pro-rata this amount for the number of days you were in the fund that month.

Deceased member accounts

We will generally rebate any account-keeping fees and administration fees charged to a deceased member's account at the end of the month in which we are first notified of their death. The amount reimbursed is calculated based on fees charged to the member for the period since the date of their death.

Investment fees and costs

Investment fees and costs are the costs of managing each option's investments. They include an investment base fee and performance fees, where applicable.

We pay these fees and costs from the fund or they are deducted from underlying investment vehicles before we calculate an investment option's unit price. They are not deducted directly from your account.

Investment base fees

Investment base fees include:

- fees paid to external investment managers,
- the costs of the Aware Super Investment team,
- amounts paid to third parties, such as our custodian, asset consultants, valuers, accountants, auditors, and tax specialists,
- the estimated costs of over-the-counter (OTC) derivatives (i.e. derivative contracts traded directly between two parties, rather than on a listed financial market), and
- securities lending costs.

Investment base fees may vary from year to year and we can't calculate them precisely in advance. The amount you'll pay in future years will depend on the fees and costs the trustee has to pay to manage the investment option.

The estimated investment base fees per Lifecycle stage and option are shown in the table on page 41.

Performance fees

While we don't charge performance fees directly, we have performance fee arrangements with a number of external investment managers within our Core and Socially Conscious investment options. These managers receive (or accrue) performance fees if they generate investment returns that exceed an agreed level. Investment managers with performance fee arrangements are generally also paid a base management fee. However, the base management fee for these managers is typically lower than it would otherwise be if there were no performance fee arrangement.

When our external managers with performance fee arrangements perform well, you'll typically pay higher investment fees and costs. Performance fees may be payable even when an investment option as a whole does not exceed its performance objective.

Performance fees are typically accrued at a frequency consistent with the valuation cycle of the relevant asset or portfolio. This means the valuations of the relevant investments factor in any performance fees owing.

These accrued amounts are included in the performance fee amounts we report and can go up and down over time. In some years, performance fees may be negative indicating the amount of performance fees owing

decreased over the relevant financial year. Performance fees are generally only paid once an investment is sold, and not all accrued performance fees will necessarily be paid.

Performance fees vary from year to year depending on:

- the individual performance fee arrangements with investment managers,
- the returns these investments generate, and
- the allocation of our investment options to these investments.

The performance fees shown in the table on page 41 are an average of the last five financial years for each investment option. For investment options that have existed for less than five financial years, performance fees are shown as the average for the period since the investment option commenced.

Performance fees have no impact on the administration fees and costs paid by you.

Transaction costs

Transaction costs may be incurred directly by the fund or by underlying investment vehicles when buying and selling assets. They are reflected in the daily unit price of each investment option. Transaction costs are an additional cost that reduces investment returns.

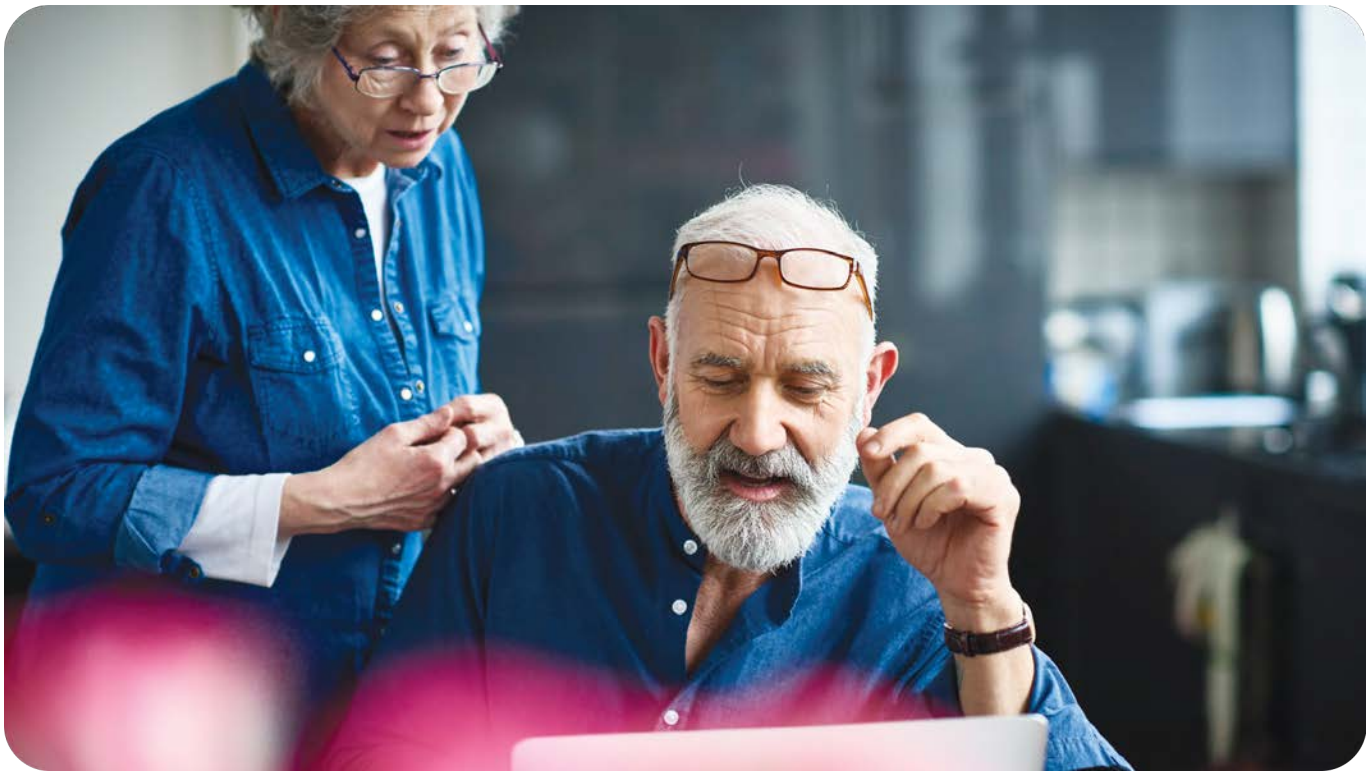
Transaction costs can include:

- brokerage costs (the amount paid to a broker when buying and selling securities such as shares)
- settlement and clearing costs (amounts paid to manage transaction settlements and reconcile orders between buyers and sellers)
- stamp duty (a government tax paid on the transfer of certain assets or property from one owner to another)
- due diligence costs (the costs of researching a potential investment, for example legal and advisory costs), and
- buy-sell spreads (costs incurred when purchasing or selling certain underlying investment vehicles).

We don't charge a buy-sell spread on our investment options. The costs incurred as a result of individual member contributions, withdrawals and switches are captured in transaction costs.

Transaction costs vary from year to year depending on the type, size and frequency of transactions. In general, illiquid asset classes such as unlisted property and infrastructure tend to have higher transaction costs than liquid asset classes like shares.

The estimated transaction costs per Lifecycle stage and option are shown on page 41.



Member activity related fees and costs

Financial advice

Intra-fund advice about your Aware Super account

As a member you have access to personal financial advice limited to your account (i.e. intra-fund advice) at no separate charge. The cost of providing this service is covered by the administration fees. This service is offered under the licence of our financial planning business which is wholly owned by Aware Super Pty Ltd as trustee of the fund. You should read their Financial Services Guide before making a decision.

Comprehensive financial advice

If you obtain broader, more complex personal advice the associated fees will depend on the scope and complexity of the advice. As trustee, we may deduct a fee from your account for personal financial product advice provided by your financial planner solely in respect of your account (this excludes advice which is not about your account e.g. about your non-super investments). This will only occur where you have authorised us to pay the fees and we have entered into an agreement with your financial planner's licensee which requires us to pay the fee.

Insurance costs

Insurance premiums are dependent on a variety of factors including the cover you have selected, your age and your insurance category. If you have insurance, the insurance premiums and an insurance administration fee of $1.85 per month will be deducted from your account.

For information on insurance fees and other costs relating to insurance, see the *Insurance Handbook*, and section 8 of the *PDS*.

Tax

For more information on the amount of tax payable, see the *Super Handbook*, and section 7 of the *PDS*.

Tax rebates on your account

If you have insurance through the fund, you'll receive a rebate on amounts deducted from your account for tax deductible insurance premiums. The rebate is credited to your account monthly, at the time the premium is deducted.

If you obtain comprehensive financial advice and we deduct the adviser fee from your account, you'll receive a rebate for tax deductible adviser fees. The rebate is credited to your account at the time the fee is deducted.

A tax deduction is claimed for the investment fees and costs and transaction costs incurred by the fund. Although there is no direct benefit passed on to you from this tax deduction, there is an indirect benefit passed on to you through lower taxation costs.

The tax benefit received by the fund for administration expenses is retained by the fund.

GST and stamp duty

Fees and costs may include GST and stamp duty. The fund may be entitled to claim a reduced input tax credit (RITC), which represents a proportion of the GST applicable to investment fees and costs and certain other expenses, as set out in the GST law.

Investment fees and costs and transaction costs are inclusive of GST and net of any RITCs at the prescribed rate. Administration fees and costs are not subject to GST. Adviser fees for comprehensive financial advice deducted from your account are inclusive of GST.

Changes to fees and costs

We can change the fees and costs that you may be charged without your consent. We'll inform you at least 30 days before we increase (or introduce new) fees that affect your account. Prior notice is not required where an increase reflects an increase in costs.

We'll update any changes to fees and costs at **aware.com.au/pdsupdates**.

Defined fees

This section defines the different fees and costs that are able to be legally charged to your Aware Super account. Not all charges apply.

Type of fee or cost	Definition	How it applies to your Aware Super Future Saver account
Activity fees	A fee is an ***activity fee*** if: a) the fee relates to costs incurred by the trustee of the superannuation entity that are directly related to an activity of the trustee: (i) that is engaged in at the request, or with the consent, of a member; or (ii) that relates to a member and is required by law; and b) those costs are not otherwise charged as administration fees and costs, investment fees and costs, transaction costs, a buy-sell spread, a switching fee, an advice fee or an insurance fee.	We do not charge activity fees.
Administration fees and costs	***Administration fees and costs*** are fees that relate to the administration or operation of the superannuation entity and includes costs incurred by the trustee of the entity that: a) relate to the administration or operation of the entity; and b) are not otherwise charged as investment fees and costs, a buy-sell spread, a switching fee, an activity fee, an advice fee or an insurance fee.	Administration fees and costs includes: a) an account-keeping fee of $52 per year *plus* b) an administration fee of 0.15% per year *plus* c) costs paid from reserves of 0.03% for the 2025/26 financial year. The administration fee component (0.15% per year) is capped at $62.50 per month ($750 per year).
Advice fees	A fee is an ***advice fee*** if: a) the fee relates directly to costs incurred by the trustee of the superannuation entity because of the provision of financial product advice to a member by: (i) a trustee of the entity; or (ii) another person acting as an employee of, or under an arrangement with, the trustee; and b) those costs are not otherwise charged as administration fees and costs, investment fees and costs, a switching fee, an activity fee or an insurance fee.	There is no charge for Intra-fund advice about your Aware Super account. However, you will be charged an advice fee if you agree to receive comprehensive personal financial advice from a financial planner. The fees will be discussed and agreed with you at that time. See 'Financial advice' on page 44 for further information.
Buy-sell spreads	A ***buy-sell spread*** is a fee to recover costs incurred by the trustee of the superannuation entity in relation to the sale and purchase of assets of the entity.	We do not charge buy-sell spreads.
Exit fees	An ***exit fee*** is a fee, other than a buy-sell spread, that relates to the disposal of all or part of a member's interests in a superannuation entity.	We do not charge exit fees.
Insurance fee	A fee is an ***insurance fee*** for a superannuation product if: a) the fee relates directly to either or both of the following: (i) insurance premiums paid by the trustee, or the trustees, of a superannuation entity in relation to a member or members of the entity; (ii) costs incurred by the trustee, or the trustees, of a superannuation entity in relation to the provision of insurance for a member or members of the entity; and b) the fee does not relate to any part of a premium paid or cost incurred in relation to a life policy or a contract of insurance that relates to a benefit to the member that is based on the performance of an investment rather than the realisation of a risk; and c) the premiums and costs to which the fee relates are not otherwise charged as administration fees and costs, investment fees and costs, transaction costs, a switching fee, an activity fee or an advice fee.	The cost of insurance cover includes the insurance premium charged by the insurer, and any insurance administration fee charged by us.

Type of fee or cost	Definition	How it applies to your Aware Super Future Saver account
Investment fees and costs	***Investment fees and costs*** are fees and costs that relate to the investment of the assets of a superannuation entity and includes: a) fees in payment for the exercise of care and expertise in the investment of those assets (including performance fees); and b) costs incurred by the trustee of the entity that: (i) relate to the investment of assets of the entity; and (ii) are not otherwise charged as administration fees and costs, a buy-sell spread, a switching fee, an activity fee, an advice fee or an insurance fee.	A breakdown of these fees and costs for each investment option and Lifecycle stage is provided in the table on page 41.
Switching fees	A ***switching fee*** for a MySuper product is a fee to recover the costs of switching all or part of a member's interest in a superannuation entity from one class of beneficial interest in the entity to another. A ***switching fee*** for a superannuation product other than a MySuper product, is a fee to recover the costs of switching all or part of a member's interest in the superannuation entity from one investment option or product in the entity to another.	We do not charge switching fees.
Transaction costs	***Transaction costs*** are costs associated with the sale and purchase of assets of the superannuation entity other than costs that are recovered by the superannuation entity charging buy-sell spreads.	The estimated transaction costs for each investment option and Lifecycle stage are provided in the table on page 41.

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Questions? We've got answers.

Contact us:

1300 650 873

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GPO Box 89, Melbourne VIC 3001